



Hindustan Times

FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.



BUILDING FOR RESILIENCE, INNOVATION,
COOPERATION AND SUSTAINABILITY

BRICS SUMMIT

12 - 13 September 2026 New Delhi, India

Emerging
Economies
Emerging
Possibilities



CBC 14129/13/0017/2627

5 dead, many trapped as Satya Niketan students' PG collapses

Hemani Bhandari, Ridhima Gupta, Saloni Bhatia and Gargi Shukla
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Five people were killed, five were injured and an unknown number were feared trapped after a five-storey building in Satya Niketan that housed Delhi University students collapsed on Sunday, another in a run of tragedies that has shaken the national capital this year and turned the spotlight on the city's frail infrastructure, poor regulatory regimes and the near-absence of a monitoring mechanism to crack down on violations.

Police said renovations were underway in the ground floor of the paying guest accommodation, known as Hostel Daze, triggering the collapse around 1.30pm. The building was between 40 and 50 years old, said officers.

Investigators said the building was owned by Haritram Bansal, a resident of Gurugram, and registered an FIR against him and unidentified others under sections 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder), 290 (negligent conduct with respect to pulling down, repairing or constructing buildings), and 125 (act endangering life or safety of others) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) at the South Campus police station.

Delhi chief minister Rekha Gupta ordered a magisterial probe



Rescue operations at Satya Niketan after the building collapse on Sunday. SANCHIT KHANNA/HT PHOTO

into the collapse.

Thirteen people were pulled out as of 1.30pm, of whom five were confirmed dead. Two of them were identified—Abhishek, a student of Motilal Nehru College, and Yuvraj.

Of those rescued, five were being treated at AIIMS in Delhi and one at Safdarjung Hospital.

continued on →

DRIVE AGAINST ILLEGAL BUILDINGS AFTER SAKET FIRE WAS CUT SHORT

A Delhi government enforcement drive against buildings and establishments violating fire-safety and construction norms ordered in the wake of the Hauz Rani fire was cut short after the initial push, said people aware of the matter.

NO BUILDING PLAN IN AREA WHERE PGs HAVE MUSHROOMED

The Satya Niketan building did not have a sanctioned plan, said a senior MCD official aware of the early assessment, raising questions about how such structures went undetected in an area where multi-storey PGs have proliferated for years.

FROM UNDER THE RUBBLE, A VIDEO AND DESPERATE CALLS FOR HELP

Hemani Bhandari, Gargi Shukla, Karn Pratap Singh and Saloni Bhatia
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The search and rescue operation at the Satya Niketan site in the Capital, where a five-storey collapsed on Sunday afternoon, was encapsulated in an 11-second video of a student—a terrified expression on his face—pinned under several layers of rubble that was shared online. Several students who were trapped were identified after their friends started calling their friends online for help.

AS RESCUE STRETCHES INTO NIGHT, KIN PRAY FOR SIGNS OF HOPE

As ambulances arrived into AIIMS's emergency area carrying victims, students and friends of those feared trapped moved between countries, made frantic calls and checked with hospitals, hoping to locate their friends, waiting for a stand of good news.

Iran threatens harder reply after US attacks

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

TEHRAN: Iran's top negotiator on Sunday threatened a more forceful response to any further US attacks after Tehran targeted American warships in their latest round of clashes.

The exchanges of fire, which began with US raids last week, came amid a deadlock in the six-month war between the two foes.

Iran has maintained its stranglehold on the strategic Strait of Hormuz while Washington continues a counter-blockade of Iranian ports.

Washington is also seeking to choke Iran's economy, rolling out sanctions on entities with financial links to the Islamic republic in a bid to force it into submission.

"The Americans must have understood that the era of proportionate responses has come to an end," said Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, who has acted as chief negotiator in talks to end the war.

"Any aggression against **continued on →**

Iran, US trade attacks as war drags on

"Trade for the world is important, until Iran changes their position or changes their government, we will have to deal with them... We are degrading their capacities... so this is a losing game for Iran."

— CHRIS WRIGHT, US energy secretary

"The Americans must have understood that the era of proportionate responses has come to an end... Any aggression against Iran's interests and security will receive a faster, more intense, and more painful response."

— MOHAMMAD BAGHER GHALIBAF, Iran's Parliament Speaker



India's crude oil import price nears \$100/barrel

Rajeev Jayaswal
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's average crude oil import price rose to nearly \$100 a barrel, its highest level in three months, amid renewed volatility in global oil markets, while consumption of key petroleum products such as petrol and diesel also increased,

according to government and industry data.

The price of the Indian crude basket was \$99.35 a barrel on Wednesday, according to the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC), and is expected to cross the \$100-mark amid renewed hostilities between the US and Iran, according to industry experts.

→P2

11 killed after drinking spurious liquor in MP

Shruti Tomar and Anupama Pateria
letters@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL: At least 11 people died and around 25 were hospitalised after allegedly consuming spurious liquor in Baraj village of Madhya Pradesh's Sagor district on the intervening night of Saturday and Sunday, prompting the district administration to order a magisterial inquiry.

A group of people from Baraj village consumed liquor on Saturday night. Their condition deteriorated soon after and they complained of nausea and vomiting.

They were rushed to hospital where five were declared dead. Six others are in serious condition and are undergoing treatment," superintendent of police Anurag Sujana said.

"Prima facie, the cause of deaths appears to be poisoning, but we are awaiting the autopsy report for confirmation. A case has been registered and investigation is underway," the SP added.

A team from the excise department also reached the village and seized liquor bottles from a local vend for forensic examination.

→P6

Rising Ganga floods Patna



Flooded Patna town on Sunday amid rising Ganga levels. →PAGES SANTOSH KUMAR/HT

UAE move may delay India's bid to extradite Mahadev app kingpin

Neeraj Chauhan
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's attempt to extradite Sourabh Chandrakar, alleged mastermind of the ₹6,000-crore Mahadev online gambling racket, from Oman has hit a hurdle, with the UAE also sending an extradition request to the West Asia country, people familiar with the matter said.

This, officials said, could delay Chandrakar's return even if New Delhi succeeds in its extradition case as India will have to wait for Oman's decision on the UAE's request.

Both the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the Enforcement Directorate (ED) are pursuing Chandrakar's extradition since the Royal

UAE HAS ALSO SENT AN EXTRADITION REQUEST TO OMAN, WHICH MAY IMPACT INDIA'S EFFORTS TO BRING BACK CHANDRAKAR

Oman Police detained him in Muscat in June based on an Interpol red notice.

"The development has the potential to delay our attempts to get him sooner," said an officer.

Officials hinted that Chandrakar, through his aides, might have arranged for a fake case to be registered against him in the UAE, which Abu Dhabi has now cited in its extradition request.

→P7

UN-BACKED WORLD MAP MUST DEPICT J&K AND LADAKH ACCURATELY: INDIA

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India on Sunday qualified its support for a UN General Assembly resolution on a map that shows the true size of countries by saying that the country's sovereign territory, including Jammu and Kashmir, must be depicted in line with New Delhi's official map.

→P7

PUNJAB OBJECTS TO APPOINTMENT OF NEW CHIEF OF HC CHANDIGARH/JALANDHAR: The Punjab government on Sunday opposed the appointment of Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra as chief justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, demanding the appointment be put on hold until the state government's views are considered. Chief minister Bhagwant Mann on X said the Punjab cabinet passed a resolution against the move.

→P5

'ISRO'S ROLE WON'T DIMINISH': AGENCY ALLAYS CONCERNS OVER PRIVATISATION

Snehal Fernandes
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Two days after nine associations representing Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) employees sought clarity on the privatisation of the space sector, ISRO-SPAC chairman Pawan Goenka and ISRO on Sunday said the agency's role would not diminish.

ISRO said its role will "strengthen in areas where its scientific expertise matters most."

→P9

India, China armies hold LAC talks in Arunachal

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Indian and Chinese armies on Sunday held corps commander-level talks at the Wacha-Danai border meeting point in Arunachal Pradesh's Kibithoo sector, days after the two countries held the 25th round of talks between their special representatives on the boundary issue in Beijing.

The military talks focused on

issues along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in the eastern sector, including maintaining peace and tranquillity along the border, people aware of the matter said.

Lieutenant General Girish Kalia, who heads the Dimapur-based 3 Corps, led the Indian side. The Army did not comment on the development.

The meeting was the first corps commander-level engagement in the sector since the special representatives' talks.

→P7

SENA MEMBERS ASSAULT HOSPITAL STAFF OVER MEDICAL BILLS; 17 BOOKED

Pankaj S Raut
letters@hindustantimes.com

PALGHAR: At least 17 people, including the Shiv Sena's Palghar district and city unit chiefs, and an MLA's son, were booked on Sunday for allegedly assaulting, abusing and threatening a hospital staff over medical bills and discharge of people injured during Dahi Handi celebrations, people aware of the matter said.

→P5

Between courts, Delhi paper leak cases caught in jurisdictional bind

Arnavjit Sur
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi's specially designated fast-track court for examination paper leaks and cheating cases is facing a jurisdictional bind that has left some cases before courts in other districts of the national capital in a limbo.

The court, set up at the Rouse Avenue Court Complex to exclusively deal with offences under

the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, is currently hearing the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case against 13 accused persons investigated by CBI—the J. J. Tint and Ben. The issue came to the fore during hearings in two separate cases—one involving alleged cheating during the CBSE EMBS and another concerning alleged cheating during the Lower Division

Clerk exam in Janakpuri. Both cases were originally pending before magistrates at Karolbagh and Dwarka courts, respectively. The bail pleas in the two cases were sent to the fast-track court, but Special Judge Ajay Gupta, presiding over the court, flagged that the Delhi HC's notification does not appear to provide for the automatic transfer of cases pending in courts outside the Rouse Avenue complex.

→P2

Satwik-Chirag soar to win China Masters title

Sandip Sikdar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty produced a stirring comeback to win the three-game thriller.

→P3



Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty produced a stirring comeback to win the three-game thriller.

DELHI MAN BEATEN TO DEATH; MINOR AMONG TWO HELD

Karn Pratap Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A 42-year-old man died after allegedly being assaulted with wooden planks by two members of a family, including a minor, following an altercation in east Delhi's Mayapuri area on Sunday, police said. A 2-year-old man and his 5-year-old brother have been held, officers said.

→P6

HAL SET TO DELIVER FIRST BATCH OF DELAYED TRAINER AIRCRAFT TO IAF

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) is set to deliver the first batch of delays of HTT-40 basic trainer aircraft to the Indian Air Force, bolstering the air force's capacity to meet its growing pilot training requirements, officials aware of the development said on Sunday.

→P7

{ IN INDONESIA }

Thousands stuck as volcano eruption halts flights



Mt Anak Krakatau volcano spews hot ash during an eruption. REUTERS

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

JAKARTA: More than 150,000 passengers were left stranded on Sunday as Indonesia shuttered its main international airport and several others, cancelling hundreds of flights after Mount Anak Krakatau spewed a plume of volcanic ash and lava from more than 150 kilometres away.

Mount Anak Krakatau erupted on Saturday, producing a fountain of lava and booming

sounds that could be heard up to a few hundred kilometres away. Two new eruptions were recorded on Sunday, officials warned.

Ash from the volcano was detected in the airspace surrounding Soekarno-Hatta International Airport, prompting authorities to initially suspend operations from 1:30 am on Sunday to 5:30 am. The suspension was extended several times, with the latest set to end at 9:30 pm.

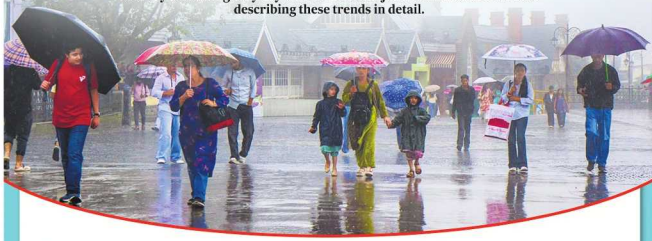
continued on →

NUMBER THEORY

Monsoon may end with July as its only bright spot

By Abhishek Jha

The June-September monsoon season is now just 10 days away from September 17, the normal date on which the weather system associated with it starts withdrawing from the most north-western corners of Rajasthan. This means that the verdict on the 2026 monsoon is almost written. What does it say? That this monsoon season has been near normal in only around one month. This means that around half of the country is running very dry and so are its major reservoirs. Here is data describing these trends in detail.

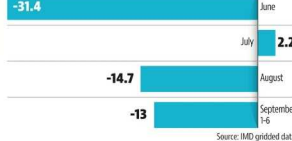


1 July is the only satisfactory monsoon month so far

According to the gridded data of the India Meteorological Department (IMD), India has received 34.6 mm rain in September so far (up to Sunday), 13% less than the 1971-2020 average, which the IMD currently considers the Long Period Average (LPA) for tracking rainfall performance. This makes it the 42nd driest September 1-6 period since 1901, the first year for which IMD has published gridded data. Similarly, August rainfall had a 14.7% deficit. While neither September nor August has a June-like deficit, they leave only July with a surplus.

Every month except July has recorded a deficit in rain so far

Country-level departure of 2026 rain from 1971-2020 average (%)

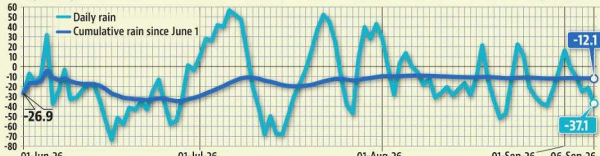


2 However, monsoon's cumulative deficit has not jumped up drastically after July

The characterisation above also holds true in daily statistics. June and August had 28 and 24 days of deficient rainfall, respectively, and September has had five, compared with only 13 in July. However, June had 20 days with a deficit of 20% or more, compared with only 10, 15, and three days in July, August, and

September so far, respectively. This has prevented the cumulative deficit from rising drastically after July. It was 10.5% on July 31, 12% on August 31, and 12.1% as of September 6. To be sure, this still makes the monsoon season so far the driest since 2009, and the 15th driest since 1901.

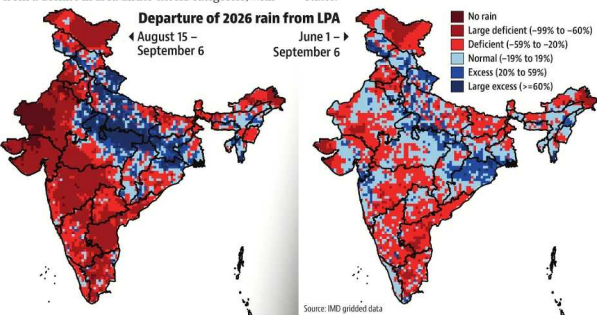
Daily rain performance of monsoon in 2026 (Country-level departure of 2026 rain from 1971-2020 average (%))



3 Almost half of the country has a deficit of at least 20%

The IMD classifies a deficit of 20%-60% as "deficient" and that of 60% or more as "large deficient" at the local level. Surpluses of the same degree are termed "excess" and "large excess", with rainfall within 20% of the LPA classified as normal. As of September 6, 49.9% of the country is in one of the deficient categories, 3.7 percentage points more than on July 31. To be sure, most of this increase has come from a decline in area under excess categories, with

the area under normal rain roughly steady at 36.6%. This is because surplus rainfall since the middle of August has shifted to a narrow band running from Uttarakhand to northern Odisha. This has decreased the deficient area by over 30 percentage points in Uttar Pradesh and Jharkhand and by 5-10 percentage points in Madhya Pradesh and Bihar between July 31 and September 6, even as such areas increased in other states.



4 Major reservoirs in most states are running dry

With August and September dry in large parts of the country, storage in 178 main reservoirs tracked by the Central Water Commission (CWC) had a deficit of 3.25% on September 3 (the data is published every Thursday). But this masks wide regional

differences. Among the 15 states with at least 1 Billion Cubic Metres (BCM) of storage, 10 had a deficit, with six having a deficit of more than 10%. Only reservoirs in Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Odisha, and Uttarakhand had a surplus.

Reservoir storage as on September 3 (% departure from normal storage)



What makes these trends especially worrying is that the extended-range forecast issued by the IMD last week projected a surplus in only small pockets until the last week of September.

{ WORLD } CAUSE NOT YET KNOWN

2 dead, 2 critical after small plane crashes in California



Two people were killed, and two others were critically injured after a small plane crashed in northwest Fresno in California, United States, on Saturday, local media reported, citing the Fresno Fire Department. According to ABC30 News, the aircraft crashed near Sierra Sky Park Airport on Bythe Avenue, while the circumstances surrounding the crash remained unclear. Two people died in the crash, while two others were taken to a hospital in critical condition, the department said. Power was briefly disrupted for nearby residents following the crash. The incident remained under investigation, with the cause of the crash not immediately known.

AGENCIES

{ SPORT } 2027 ELECTION

Infantino shrugs off calls to quit, seeks fourth FIFA term



FIFA President Gianni Infantino will stand for re-election, world football's governing body said on Sunday. Infantino has faced increasing pressure over his failed plan to sell stakes in the World Cup. Despite widespread calls for him to step down, FIFA said Infantino will seek next year to win a fourth and final term in office through 2031. The FIFA President announced in April that he will stand for re-election in 2027. Of course, nothing has changed. Mr. Infantino will be standing for re-election, a FIFA spokesperson said. UEFA, European football's governing body, has led the calls for Infantino to go, saying it had lost confidence in him and previously threatening to boycott FIFA tournaments.

AFP

Paper-leak, cheating cases in Deni face jurisdiction hurdle

Arnabjit Sur

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi's specially designated fast-track court for examination paper leaks and cheating cases is facing a jurisdictional hurdle that has left some cases pending before courts in other districts of the national capital in limbo.

The court, set up at the Rouse Avenue Court Complex to exclusively deal with offences under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, is currently hearing the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case against 13 accused persons investigated by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) — the only case assigned to it.

The problem came to the fore during hearings this week in two separate cases — one involving alleged cheating during the CBSE EMRS recruitment examination at Semapur, and another concerning alleged cheating during the Lower Divisional Clerk examination in Janakpuri.

The cases were originally pending before magistrates at Karkardooma and Dwarka courts, respectively. Their bail applications were subsequently sent to the newly designated fast-track court, but Special Judge Ajay Gupta, presiding over the court, flagged that the Delhi High Court's notification does not appear to provide for the automatic transfer of cases pending in courts outside the Rouse Avenue complex.

At least two cases caught between two courts

The first case relates to an incident reported on March 24 at Semapur, where police allege that 19 candidates used electronic devices to cheat during the CBSE EMRS recruitment examination for the post of hostel ward.

The accused were arrested and booked under provisions of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. The case was pending before a magistrate at the Karkardooma court, where charges are yet to be framed.

On September 3, however, the matter came before the fast-track court when one of the accused, Sourabh Kumar, filed a bail application.

Kumar's counsel argued that the case had been sent to the fast-track court because the newly designated court had exclusive jurisdiction over cases relating to cheating and other offences covered by the anti-paper leak law.

The defence relied on an August 24 order of Special Judge Vineet Kumar of Karkardooma court. In that order, the court recorded the prosecution's submission that matters relating to cheating in public examinations were to be "exclusively tried" by the fast-track court.

A similar issue arose in the Janakpuri case, relating to the alleged use of mobile phones by

SAHDEV VERMAHT

letters@hindustantimes.com

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act was enacted in 2024 to tackle malpractices in exams.

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

SAHDEV VERMAHT

MY BENGALURU

KPSC probe: Candidates seek vet officers re-exam

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Candidates challenging the veterinary officers' recruitment process of the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) have sought a fresh examination for all 400 posts, as the Criminal Investigation Department (CID) is investigating alleged manipulation of the examination and selection process.

The aspirants have submitted representations to anti-rangaswamy minister Puttaranga Shetty and Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) president BK Hanumanth, arguing that the alleged irregularities have made it impossible to determine which candidates received an unfair advantage and which qualified without assistance.

The candidates have cited 10 grounds for seeking a re-examination. Among them principal allegations is that the veterinary officer question paper was leaked and subsequently distributed and resold. They have also cited questions were circulated while the examination was in progress.

INVESTIGATORS HAVE REPORTEDLY FOUND CASES OF CANDIDATES WHO DID NOT OBTAIN REQUIRED MARKS, OR HAD FAILED, CAME IN THE FINAL SELECTION LIST'

Concerns have also been raised over the handling of OMR answer sheets. The candidates allege that answers were corrected or altered after candidates had completed their papers. They have further alleged that attempts were made to destroy evidence connected with the alleged malpractice.

The aspirants have questioned the difficulty of the question paper as well, alleging that it was made deliberately difficult even though several of the advertised vacancies remained unfilled. They have also raised questions over what they described as 'suspicious grades' awarded during the evaluation process.

The candidates said the com-

mission of these allegations had undermined confidence in the recruitment exercise. They have also referred to the mental stress faced by aspirants who believe they were denied a fair opportunity.

Their demand for a fresh examination comes as the CID examines alleged irregularities in KPSC recruitment. Investigators have reportedly found cases in which candidates who did not obtain the required marks, or had failed an examination, appeared in the final selection list.

The agency is examining examination records, answer scripts, marks awarded and selection lists to determine how candidates with reportedly inadequate scores came to be included among those selected and whether any manipulation took place during preparation of the final list, an officer aware of the details said.

A diary record from Basavaraiah Kanale, a suspect in the investigation, has also come to the fore. According to investigators, it contains the names of several candidates connected to the veterinary officer recruitment.

CM SHIVAKUMAR URGES STUDENTS TO STUDY ABROAD, BE 'JOB CREATORS'

BENGALURU: Chief minister DK Shivakumar on Sunday urged students to study abroad and become job creators, not job seekers.

He was speaking after launching the Skill Development Department's 'Study Abroad 2026' programme in Bengaluru. The programme, inaugurated at Police Grounds, offers students opportunities to pursue higher education at foreign universities, with more than 80 universities participating and over 300 subjects on offer. "Our talented human resources are unmatched by those in any other state in the country. We want our children to learn at the global level. We desire that they should not merely become employees, but become employers," Shivakumar said.

He said the government had opened a new avenue for overseas education and stressed that investment in knowledge was the best asset. "Human beings have limitations, but knowledge has no boundaries. Access to global-level education makes people mentally stronger". Shivakumar said 3,145 students had been selected to study at foreign universities. He said scholarships were being offered by various government departments. He also mentioned providing education loans of up to ₹2 crore.

(With agency inputs)

₹4L drugs seized from e-comm facilities: FDA

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: The Karnataka Food Safety and Drug Administration (FDA) seized medicines worth ₹4,02,352 from two unlicensed commercial storage facilities, and in a separate inspection, found 40 bottles of expired soft drinks and pest infestation at Bengaluru's Hockey Club, officials said on Sunday.

According to officials, the drug seizures followed raids at the facilities in Thattannahalli in Anekal taluk and Aerospace in Devanahalli on Sunday. The food safety inspection on Saturday at the Hockey Club, within Greater Bengaluru Authority limits, found violations involving expired products, food labelling, hygiene and pest control, they said.

At Thattannahalli, a team led by Manohar, assistant drugs controller with the state intelligence branch, and regional drugs inspectors searched the premises of M/s Amazon Seller Services Pvt Ltd. Medicines valued at ₹2,53,382 were seized from the facility after they were found stored without a valid drug licence, the FDA said in a release.

A separate team led by Vibha, drugs inspector, Bangalore Rural, inspected the M/s Amazon facility at Aerospace in Devanahalli and seized medicines worth ₹1,57,000 from the unlicensed premises, the release said.

A FOOD SAFETY INSPECTION AT THE HOCKEY CLUB ALSO FOUND 40 BOTTLES OF EXPIRED SOFT DRINKS AND PEST INFESTATION

The department said the operations were based on 'precise intelligence' regarding major compliance breaches and described the raids as a 'swift and coordinated crackdown on the illegal storage and distribution of pharmaceuticals'.

HT reached out to Amazon India through email for a response, but the company had not responded till the time of going to press.

Meanwhile, the food safety inspection at the Hockey Club found 40 bottles of expired soft drinks in storage, along with soda bottles whose labelling did not meet requirements prescribed by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) officials said.

The inspection report also recorded unhygienic conditions in areas used for preparing and storing food. Officials found pest infestation in food preparation areas and said the presence of pests had created conditions that could lead to contamination.

The Food Safety Division

issued a notice to the club's food business operator following the inspection. Expired food products and items carrying non-compliant labels were also seized.

The department said the deficiencies involved both food safety and hygiene requirements and that further proceedings would be taken under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 and the applicable regulations.

"In view of the deficiencies observed relating to food safety and hygiene, a notice has been issued to the concerned Food Business Operator (FBO), and further legal action will be initiated as per the provisions of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 and the applicable Regulations, 2011," the department said.

The inspection was conducted under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 and the Food Safety and Standards (Licensing and Registration) Regulations, 2011.

The department said inspections of establishments involved in the manufacture, storage and sale of food would continue. "Continuous inspections will be carried out against food manufacturing, storage and sale establishments violating food safety and quality standards, and stringent legal action will be taken as per the applicable laws and regulations," it said.

HT reached out to the Hockey Club, but did not get a response.

Ex-CM demands 75% quota for Dalits, OBCs, minorities

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Former chief minister Siddaramaiah on Sunday called for implementation of the caste census and increase of reservation for Dalits, backward communities and minorities to 75%, saying an egalitarian society could not be achieved without equal opportunities based on population.

Speaking at the Karnataka State Backward Castes Federation's Silver Jubilee celebration here, Siddaramaiah said the caste survey report must be implemented and asserted that reservation should be provided according to the population of each community.

"If all of you are to get social justice, there must be at least 75% reservation. Dalits, backward communities and minorities—all of them must get 75 per cent," he said.

Only when everyone gets reservation among their caste and according to their population will it be possible to create an egalitarian society, he said, adding that similar reservation based on caste and population in the Lok Sabha and Legislative Assembly is necessary to achieve political equality.

Siddaramaiah said the caste survey must be implemented. He was referring to the report



Siddaramaiah

submitted by the Backward Castes Commission headed by Madhusudan Naik, which he said he had accepted before demitting office as chief minister.

He said a court order currently prevented the report from being implemented or made public, and said he had conveyed the matter to federation president Ramachandrapada.

Siddaramaiah said the survey was necessary as there were no accurate figures on the population of backward communities. He recalled that he had ordered a survey when he became chief minister in 2013, but the report was not completed during his tenure. He alleged that the subsequent government did not accept the report.

"We have been saying, 'Equal share for everyone'," he said. Siddaramaiah said the struggle against the caste system must continue until equality and equal opportunities were achieved.

"As long as the caste system exists in society, as long as an equal society is not created and

as long as equal opportunities are not provided to everyone, the struggle must continue," he said.

The former chief minister said the caste system had historically deprived large sections of society of education and opportunities. Siddaramaiah said he had personally experienced the absence of reservation and claimed that reservation in education and employment had helped expand opportunities for disadvantaged communities.

Highlighting measures taken during his tenure, he said the Backward Classes Department's budget had increased from ₹5 crore when it was established to ₹4,461 crore in 2025-27.

There were now 2,712 hostels housing 2,58 lakh backward community students, he said. Siddaramaiah also recalled starting Moraji Desai residential school in 2013, which provided ₹1,500 per month to students who could not secure hostel accommodation.

The former chief minister said the reservation represented 752 of the State's 806 backward communities and argued that other categories, including 2B, 3A and 3B, should also be brought into the fold. He also criticised the electoral system, saying it had become "very expensive" and needs to be reformed.



Chief minister DK Shivakumar with US ambassador to India, Sergio Gora, and US consul general Marilena Neisner during an event marking the 250 years of American freedom.

CM calls for deeper ties between India and U.S.

BENGALURU: Chief Minister DK Shivakumar on Sunday called for deeper India-US cooperation in technology, education, innovation, research, investment and culture, pitching Bengaluru as a key technology and innovation hub in the strategic partnership between the two countries.

Addressing an event marking the 250th anniversary of American independence, in the presence of US Ambassador to India Sergio Gora, Shivakumar said the India-US relationship was moving beyond traditional government-to-government engagement, with universities, scientists, entrepreneurs, startups and businesses playing an increasingly important role.

"Washington and New Delhi may guide the strategic partnership between our countries. But Bengaluru and Silicon Valley give it a powerful technological dimension," he said.

Shivakumar said Karnataka was keen to expand cooperation with the US in artificial intelligence, semiconductors, aerospace, advanced manufacturing, digital technologies and scientific research.

"Karnataka's ambition is to be among those who shape, build and lead the technologies of tomorrow," he said.

Highlighting economic ties, he said more than 1,000 American companies operated in Karnataka, accounting for nearly half of the total American corporate presence in India, while more than 80,000 American citizens lived in Bengaluru.

Church festivities



Children shower flowers on a statue of Mother Mary as part of preparations for the Monthi Fest at a church in Mangaluru on Sunday.

COUPLE ATTACKED UNDER FLYOVER, 3 MINORS AMONG 5 HELD: POLICE

Coovercolly Indresh
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Five people, including three minors have been apprehended in connection with an alleged attack on a couple travelling in an auto-rickshaw, during which the woman was allegedly sexually assaulted, police said on Sunday.

The incident occurred around 10 p.m. on Saturday under the ITC Flyover after the couple, who had been visiting a friend, were returning home. Police said five or six men on motorcycles allegedly stopped the auto-rickshaw, threatened the couple and the driver with a knife, assaulted them and took their mobile phones, jewellery and purses.

The woman, 30, was allegedly pulled out of the auto-rickshaw and sexually assaulted in front of her husband. He screams alleging the attackers to leave the area. The couple later went to Pulikeshi Nagar police station and filed a complaint. Investigators began examining CCTV recordings from the flyover and nearby locations to establish the identities and roles of those involved.

DCP Vikram Ananth said investigators were still determining the precise offences involved. "We are verifying whether it is a case of robbery or molestation, since the accused held the mobile phones. We have arrested five persons, including three minors, in connection with the case and recovered mobile phones. The investigation is ongoing," Ananth said.

Police are questioning the five arrested people to establish what each person allegedly did and reconstruct the sequence of events. "The accused are under police custody now. We are verifying their previous records and whether they have been involved in similar acts earlier," the DCP said.

Got hundreds of calls welcoming 'Tr' prefix for teachers, says CM

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Chief minister DK Shivakumar on Sunday said that the state government's decision to allow teachers to use the prefix 'Tr' before their names was a mark of respect was widely welcomed.

"Our government has decided to add 'Tr' (Teacher) before teachers' names to honour them. I have received hundreds of calls welcoming the decision. We regard teachers as gods and have taken steps to recognise and respect their contribution," the chief minister said.

The state government formally approved the honourific on Teachers' Day, September 5. "Permission has been granted to use this term respectfully, considering the invaluable contribution of teachers who continuously strive for the building of a better society and the educational advancement of students," the order said.

The government said Karnataka has about 450,000 teachers, while more than 10 million teachers work across the India. It said teachers play a role in shaping the minds, character and future of children every day. Thus, the government has decided to honour the invaluable contribution of this category with a unique symbol of respect. From Teachers' Day (Sept. 5), teachers in the state can proudly use the prefix 'Tr' before their names. It is not just two letters, but represents the lifelong service of a teacher," the government said.

GOVT APPROVED THE HONORIFIC FOR TEACHERS ON TEACHERS' DAY. IT SAID THE PREFIX DOES NOT SIGNIFY AN ACADEMIC QUALIFICATION

The decision was announced by Shivakumar while speaking at the launch of the Praja Seva programme in Kudligi, Vijayanagara district on Saturday. "From today, teachers of Karnataka can proudly use the prefix 'Tr' before their names," Shivakumar said.

He said teachers deserved recognition for their contribution to the country and called for wider acceptance of the prefix as a mark of respect. "The contribution of teachers is as important as that of soldiers, workers and farmers for the development of the country. Therefore, in the coming days, everyone should follow the tradition of adding 'Tr' before the name of teachers to show respect," Shivakumar said.

The government order describes "Tr" as an honorific for members of the teaching profession. The prefix is not an academic qualification and does not indicate possession of an additional degree or certification. "The government said the contribution of teachers extends beyond classroom teaching. According to the order, teachers help students with career guidance, build their confidence, encourage scientific thinking and contribute to the development of Constitutional values. "A society that honours its teachers honours its future," Shivakumar said in his Teachers' Day message.

(With PTI inputs)



Khet Singh Rajput, left, and Amit Baddi, with Bhushan Borase.

[BORASE SAYS DIDN'T KNOW PERSONALLY]

Lankesh accused fetes police commissioner

Coovercolly Indresh
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: An accused in the Gauri Lankesh murder case and a man facing a case under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act (NDPS) were photographed felicitating newly-appointed Hubballi-Dharwad police commissioner Bhushan Borase at his office, even as the officer clarified that he did not personally know anyone who came to his office.

The photographs circulated online purportedly show the Lankesh murder case accused Amit Baddi, and Khet Singh Rajput, who has an NDPS case against him, presenting bouquets to Borase after he assumed charge.

Borase told HT that more than

200 people from different sections of society had met him during the three days since he took office. "I do not personally know everyone who came to greet me. My intention is to make the police people-friendly, and therefore I did not refuse anyone who came to greet me. People came in groups, and I could not notice everyone individually. However, my stand against criminals remains as tough as before," he said.

Borase had spoken about curbing the illegal drug trade in Hubballi-Dharwad after taking charge.

Baddi is out on bail over the murder of activist and journalist Gauri Lankesh on September 5, 2017. If charged he would be out on bail, while one accused remains absconding.

[IN SHOW OF STRENGTH AGAINST JD(S) FIRST FAMILY]

MLA GT Deve Gowda takes out procession amid JDK rift

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

MYSURU: In an apparent show of strength against the first family of his party JD(S), MLA GT Deve Gowda on Sunday held a massive procession without the posters or names of the party leaders in Mysuru.

He asserted that the massive gathering of people from his constituency was a demonstration of their affection and support for him, and apparent differences with JD(S) second-in-command HD Kumaraswamy, who had recently said Gowda's victory in the constituency was not due to an individual.

"For three years, people from my own party have insulted me. Even though I am an MLA, I was not invited to any party programme. I am holding this procession to respond to that humiliation," Deve Gowda said.

"This is not my show of strength. It is a symbol of the people's love," he said, as thousands of his supporters from Chamundeshwari constituency took part in a massive procession from Kote Anjaneya Swamy Temple to JK Grounds.

Deve Gowda, who recently became president of the state Cooperative Federation, said the people had stood by him despite



GT Deve Gowda

being sidelined by his party. "The people of Chamundeshwari constituency have told me that I should not sit in a corner where they assured their support to me".

The procession saw the participation of people from villages across the Chamundeshwari constituency. Deve Gowda was felicitated with two huge angaridas and a giant rose garland, which were lifted using JCB machines. Flowers were also showered on him using five JCB machines.

The event was organised without photographs or flags of other JD(S) leaders, in what appeared to be an effort to project Gowda's independent support base in the constituency.

Speaking to reporters, Gowda said his supporters had rallied behind him despite attempts to keep him away from party pro-

grammes. "Even though I am a sitting Janata Dal MLA, they (JD-S leadership) have kept me away and neglected me. Those who have suffered this pain have come here today," he said.

Gowda also referred to the recent election to the Cooperative Federation, alleging that efforts were made to prevent his election as president. "But chief minister DK Shivakumar and cooperation minister Lakshman Savadi called everyone and took a decision that I should be made president. So, I was unanimously elected," he said.

The development comes days after Kumaraswamy said the JD(S)'s strength in Chamundeshwari was not attributable to any individual and credited party workers and voters for its electoral victory.

"You have proved that the Chamundeshwari constituency is a stronghold of the Janata Dal. This is the only thing that has happened because of an individual," Kumaraswamy had said without mentioning the name of Deve Gowda.

He said he had continuously won this constituency over the last three times, it has not been because of an individual. In my opinion, this victory belongs to the blessed people of this constituency and my workers," he said.

'In 2026 defeat, is CPI(M) faultless?' LoP's remarks stir row before meet

Vishnu Varma

letters@hindustantimes.com

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: On August 29, Pinarayi Vijayan, Leader of the Opposition and CPI(M)'s tallest leader in the state, lashed out at V Kunhirishnan, a former party leader who broke ranks and contested as a rebel to eventually win as a UDF-backed candidate in Pannamur in Kannur district, a constituency the CPI(M) had never lost in its electoral history.

"The defeat happened because there were people, who while remaining part of the party, played into the hands of its opponents. While being at the leadership level, efforts were made to destroy the party's credibility and alliances were established with the party's enemies," said Vijayan at a party rally held to explain its defeat in Pannamur.

He called Kunhirishnan an "axe in the hands of the party's enemies." A clear campaign was run against our party with the help of its enemies. As a result, the people struggled to have a clear idea in their minds," he said.

Vijayan's remarks baffled many, especially the cadre of the CPI(M), because his speech did not have a word on the financial misappropriation allegations against him sitting. Pannamur MLA TI Madhusoodanan - seen by many to have had a direct bearing on its defeat. While he acknowledged the allegations against him sitting, Pannamur MLA TI Madhusoodanan - seen by many to have had a direct bearing on its defeat. While he acknowledged the allegations against him sitting, Pannamur MLA TI Madhusoodanan - seen by many to have had a direct bearing on its defeat.



Pinarayi Vijayan's recent remarks stand in contrast to views expressed by party's senior leadership and the report prepared by central committee following the election results.

Two days later, on August 31 in Taliparamba, another constituency, the CPI(M) lost to a rebel leader, Vijayan went to step further and blamed voters and a section of party workers for deserting the outfit.

"There may be people who stray from the party looking for positions. In some extreme cases, there may be action against them. But ordinary party workers, who hold the ideology dear in their hearts, should not have gone after them. You must now acknowledge the mistake you committed," Vijayan told his listeners at a rally.

The former CM claimed there was a "statewide propaganda" against the party during the election campaign. But Taliparamba should not have fallen for such propaganda, he said.

"There are people who hold

CPI(M) and Left Front in their hearts. A section of them did not vote for the LDF. That's serious. They accepted TK Govindan (rebel) without ascertaining the facts or understanding the truth. Now, they must introspect," he said in remarks widely interpreted as terming the party "faultless".

Vijayan's words, in many ways, have amplified the impression that the CPI(M) leadership, even after a humiliating defeat in the assembly elections in Kerala, is failing to rectify its mistakes, or worse, even acknowledging that there were errors.

It has also led to reports of a deep rift within the organisation as it prepares to hold an extended state committee meeting in the second week of September to review the election results.

In the assembly elections held in April, the CPI(M)-led LDF was routed, winning just 35 out of 140 seats with a vote share of 37.64%, the first time in two decades that it's vote share dropped below 40% in state elections. The Congress-led UDF won the polls with 102 seats and the BJP a distant third with three seats.

Vijayan's recent remarks stand in contrast to the views expressed by the party's own senior leadership as well as the report prepared by the central committee in Delhi following the election results.

For one, the central committee underlined the state committee's findings about candidate lapses in Pannamur and Taliparamba. It also said that there was a growing gap between the leadership and the rank and file. The central committee questioned whether ideals of inner-party democracy and democratic centralism were being followed at the state and grassroots levels.

Senior CPI(M) leader and former finance minister TM Thomas Isaac, at a public meeting in Alappuzha on September 1, said that the members of the central committee.

"If someone leaves our party, we should let him go, we don't have to answer him. But that minister should not be allowed to do that. We should correct ourselves. We should also convince people that we have corrected ourselves," he told a section of party workers.

Isaac's stands in contrast to that of Vijayan's, hinting at the fissures within the party. While there is no open dissent

towards the former chief minister yet, who is widely seen as having an iron grip on the party affairs in the state, all indications point to a stormy state committee meeting ahead.

CPI(M) general secretary MA Baby told reporters on Sunday, "The party is subjecting itself to an internal examination. When there's an illness, there arises a need for an Ayurvedic treatment and some forms of massages. We will sit together and point to each other's faults and lapses and help each other ultimately."

J Prabhakar, former professor of political science at Kerala University, said that the remarks of the LoP point to a "leadership crisis" within the CPI(M) in Kerala.

"No one is in a position to correct Vijayan even when he makes such remarks. That's the result of 27 years of Vijayan's 'raj' within the party, first as state secretary and then as chief minister. He has seen to it that no leader can replace him. The party cannot project a face as an alternative to Vijayan," said Prabhakar.

He said that the CPI(M) should experiment with a collegium form of leadership if it cannot unite on a single name as a successor to Vijayan.

Isaac said a collegium can include faces like former health minister KK Shailaja, former Speaker AN Shamsheer, former industries minister P Jajeev and former finance minister KN Balagopal. The party should build a second rung of leadership. Otherwise, it will be finished," said the professor.

DMK SLAMS TVK'S MOVE

It identifies 2 potential sites for second airport

S Vijay Karthik

letters@hindustantimes.com

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu government has identified two sites near Chennai for the ambitious second airport near Chennai and a team of officials have completed the preliminary study. People aware of the matter said on Sunday.

The two sites identified are Cheyur in Chengalpattu district (about 100 km south of Chennai) and the other at Manelore near Gummidipundi in Tiruvallur district (about 50 km north-west of Chennai) to have the potential for establishing the ambitious airport.

Citing environmental concerns, the ruling Tamilaga Vetri Kazhagam government in August scrapped the proposal to set up an airport at Parandur in Kancheepuram district, a flagship project announced by the former chief minister M K Stalin during the previous DMK regime.

The government officials indicated that the two sites may be suitable for establishing an airport considering the geographical location and submitted a report to the Airport Authority of India (AAI).

Meanwhile, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) criticised the TVK government's move for first cancelling the project at Parandur and then ordering a fresh survey.

THE TWO SITES ARE CHEYUR IN CHENGALPATU DISTRICT (ABOUT 100 KM SOUTH OF CHENNAI) AND AT MANELORE NEAR GUMMIDIPUNDI IN TIRUVALLUR DISTRICT (ABOUT 50 KM NORTH-WEST OF CHENNAI)

DMK spokesperson TKS Elangovan said, "Everything was ready in Parandur (for establishing an airport). But, they (TVK government) wanted to cancel. They want to open a new airport in Cheyur and Gummidipundi. I do not understand why this is happening."

Based on the submission of the report by the state government, a team from Airports Authority of India (AAI) is expected to take a visit for an inspection. A government official had said earlier even a location and land has been identified. It would at least take five years for the airport to commence operations.

Announcing the decision to drop the second airport at Parandur near Chennai, Vijay making a suo motu statement in the assembly on Sunday.

"Proceeding with this plan despite knowing the facts—such as the lack of sufficient land in Gummidipundi, its proximity to Sriharikota (spaceport of Indian Space Research Organisation), and the presence of the Vedanthangal Bird Sanctuary and the Kalpakkam Nuclear Power Plant near Cheyur—would be the height of irresponsibility," Thirupathi said.

Assembly on August 24, said his government decided to scrap that project and look for an alternative site due to concerns over waterbodies, agricultural lands, flooding.

Impulsive decision: BJP Terming the decision "impulsively" and without due deliberation, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) spokesperson Narayanan Thirupathi said, "It is noteworthy that both these locations (Cheyur and Manelore near Gummidipundi) were previously deemed unsuitable for an airport."

"Furthermore, neither of these sites was included in the four locations originally short-listed," he said.

Having abandoned the Parandur airport project for political reasons—thereby missing out on state's immense economic growth—the government now realises its mistake but continues to compound mistakes in haste. The BJP spokesperson said in a statement on Sunday.

"Proceeding with this plan despite knowing the facts—such as the lack of sufficient land in Gummidipundi, its proximity to Sriharikota (spaceport of Indian Space Research Organisation), and the presence of the Vedanthangal Bird Sanctuary and the Kalpakkam Nuclear Power Plant near Cheyur—would be the height of irresponsibility," Thirupathi said.

COUPLE FOUND DEAD IN LAKE, SUICIDE SUSPECTED

Press Trust of India

letters@hindustantimes.com

KOLLAM: A young couple who had chosen to live together against opposition from their families were found dead in a lake in this district, in an apparent suicide, police said on Sunday.

The 26-year-old - aged 19 and 26 - are believed to have reached the lake on Saturday evening and jumped into the water. Their bodies were recovered Sunday morning, police said. According to police, the two had been in a relationship for some time and had been living together in recent months. Their relationship had earlier led to intervention by police after their families approached them.

When the couple was called to the court recently, they told police that they had decided to live together and gave a written statement, signed by both of them. They continued to live together, but their families were not in agreement.

HELP IS JUST A CALL AWAY
SHEIN: 01-65978181
SUITMATTER: 01-66018404
9315767849

45-year-old TVK functionary murdered by five, all accused arrested, say police

S Vijay Karthik

letters@hindustantimes.com

CHENNAI: A 45-year-old Tamilaga Vetri Kazhagam (TVK) functionary was allegedly murdered by a group of five people in Chennai's Adyar, police said on Sunday, adding that all the accused have been arrested.

The murder has also triggered sharp political reactions with the Opposition parties slamming the TVK government over the law and order situation.

According to police, the deceased was earlier in the IT wing of the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK). In 2025, he joined the TVK and has been an office bearer of the party's Chennai South district.

Police said the incident, that appears to have stemmed from previous enmity, took place late on Saturday.

The deceased was identified as S Kannan, a resident of Vandalur area (in Adyar) and ran a business of renting cars to IT companies in Chennai and neighbourhood districts.

MURDER ALSO TRIGGERED SHARP POLITICAL REACTIONS WITH THE OPPOSITION PARTIES SLAMMING THE TVK GOVERNMENT OVER THE LAW AND ORDER SITUATION

Police said the deceased had multiple "cases" registered against him, with charges including that of murder.

"Kannan was attacked by five unidentified individuals on Saturday morning on two wheelers, attacked him with knives and fled. He died on the spot," a police officer said.

Kannan's friend, who witnessed the crime, said: "Initially, two people wearing helmets came on a motorcycle and attacked Kannan with knives. Later, they were joined by three more people who attacked him with machetes. We ran away as

they tried to attack as well. We could not recognise them," he said.

A case was registered on a complaint filed by Kannan's maternal-uncle Purushothaman.

The accused were identified as Bharath (20), Rakesh (20), Nareesh (20), Manikandan (20), Hariharan (20), and were arrested under various sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), he said.

"They have been arrested and an investigation is underway," a police officer said.

The officer said in 2009, Kannan and his associates murdered Siva, the maternal uncle of Bharani, one of the five accused.

"Bharani's father Venu was also murdered in Saidapet. Due to this prior enmity, Bharani and his accomplices committed the crime. An investigation was launched," he added.

Meanwhile, Tamil Nadu Leader of the Opposition and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) leader A Bhavanthi said the BJP-led government and chief minister C Joseph

they tried to attack as well. We could not recognise them," he said.

A case was registered on a complaint filed by Kannan's maternal-uncle Purushothaman.

The accused were identified as Bharath (20), Rakesh (20), Nareesh (20), Manikandan (20), Hariharan (20), and were arrested under various sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), he said.

"They have been arrested and an investigation is underway," a police officer said.

The officer said in 2009, Kannan and his associates murdered Siva, the maternal uncle of Bharani, one of the five accused.

"Bharani's father Venu was also murdered in Saidapet. Due to this prior enmity, Bharani and his accomplices committed the crime. An investigation was launched," he added.

Meanwhile, Tamil Nadu Leader of the Opposition and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) leader A Bhavanthi said the BJP-led government and chief minister C Joseph

Vijay. "A history-sheeter who joined the ruling TVK seeking protection for his life has been chased and killed in broad daylight on the street. Is this Tamil Nadu's successful law and order situation?" the former deputy CM said.

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) spokesperson Narayanan Thirupathi said, "Even if the government has changed, the ground reality has not."

"Whatever the motive, the police must understand that their foremost duty is to prevent crimes from happening and not merely respond after it has occurred," he added.

Patil Makkal Katchi (PMK) lawmaker Anbumani Ramadoss said this incident indicates has caused fear among the public.

"Such incidents demonstrate that no effective measures have been taken to prevent murders and robberies in Chennai and its suburban areas," he said.

The TVK spokesperson declined to comment despite various attempts by Hindustan Times.

Press Trust of India

letters@hindustantimes.com

MALAPPURAM: Two people were killed and three others injured after a tipper lorry collided with a car on National Highway-66 in this district early Sunday morning, police said.

The deceased were residents of Koomanna in Malappuram. The three injured, who were travelling in the car with them, were taken to the casualty ward of Kozhikode Medical College. The condition of two of the injured is critical, police said. All five were friends.

According to police, the accident took place around 3.30 am on the Kozhikode-Thiruvananthapuram NH-66 stretch at Idumukhal.

A stone-carrying tipper lorry entered the highway and, after proceeding a short distance, took a U-turn to enter a field, where it collided with the car approaching from the opposite direction, police said. Residents cut open the car to pull out the passengers trapped inside.

Though all five were rushed to the hospital, two were declared brought dead, police said. The bodies have been kept at the Kozhikode Medical College.

Thenipalam police reached the spot, removed the damaged vehicles from the road and restored traffic movement. Police have registered a case and launched an investigation.



The damaged car after it lost control and rammed into a motorcycle on the Guruvayur-Kunnankulam road in Thrissur on Sunday.

3 of family killed as car hits bike in Kerala

Press Trust of India

letters@hindustantimes.com

THRISUR: Three members of a family were killed when a speeding car hit their motorcycle in this district, police said on Sunday.

The deceased were identified as Munner (35), Shifina (24) and their three-year-old son Emil Aibak, all residents of Edakkazh Ayur.

The accident occurred around midnight on Saturday. Police said the car was travelling at high speed when it hit the motorcycle carrying the family.

The car driver was allegedly

drunk at the time of the accident, police said.

The car and two passengers travelling in it were taken into custody, while the driver is absconding, they said.

The car and motorcycle were completely damaged in the accident.

The accident occurred amid the shock over the death of eight students from Tamil Nadu in a car-lorry collision at Kaipamangalam in the district. The tragic accident took place late on Friday night when the vehicle carrying the youths collided with the rear of a parked lorry on the highway at Panambikkum in Kaipamangalam.

KERALAM PRIVATE BUS OPERATORS THREATEN STRIKE

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Private bus operators in Kerala may launch an indefinite strike next week to demand a hike in minimum fares after claiming the ruling government's decision to allow private bus operators to share up to 10% of the state government's 'Priyadarshini' scheme, which offers free rides to women in the ordinary class of KSRTC buses.

The operators' association claimed the recommendations of an expert committee, appointed by the government to study private bus sector, to shore up revenues are inadequate.

T Gopinathan, general secretary of the All Kerala Bus Operators Association (AKBOA), said the outfit's members plan to meet on September 8 in Palakkad to decide on launching the indefinite strike. "The recommendations in the report submitted by the expert committee are inadequate for private bus operators to sustain our business. We see no recommendations by the committee regarding the fare increase," he said.

Several demands of AKBOA, including zero ticketing for women, diesel subsidy and hike in student fares, were not supported by the expert committee, he added.

Will adopt coalition name on Sept 9: TN min

CHENNAI: The ruling alliance in Tamil Nadu will officially adopt a unified coalition name during a scheduled meeting on September 9 to establish a distinct political identity, state health minister K G Arunai announced on Sunday.

He said, "We'll give a name, as our alliance partners are ready to have an identity and build on it."

Addressing recent criticisms from the Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin regarding law and order, Arunai assured that chief minister C Joseph Vijay would deliver a comprehensive reply in the Assembly.

72-year-old man kills wife for refusing to cook pork cury
HYDERABAD: A 66-year-old woman was allegedly killed by her 72-year-old husband after an argument over cooking pork cury in Telangana's Nalgonda district, police said on Sunday.

The incident took place late on Saturday when the woman was asleep at their house in Shabdullapur village. The man allegedly attacked her with a sharp knife, inflicting injuries to her forehead, chest and abdomen that proved fatal, an officer said.

Based on a complaint filed by the couple's daughter, police registered a murder case at Kanagal police station and arrested the man on Sunday.

T'gana monsoon session set for stormy start today

Press Trust of India

letters@hindustantimes.com

HYDERABAD: The monsoon session of the Telangana assembly beginning on Monday is expected to be stormy as the ruling Congress and main opposition BRS prepare to lock horns over the government's policies on various issues.

Asserting that his government was ready to debate on all issues, chief minister A Revanthi Reddy accused BRS president K Chandrashekar Rao of "confining himself to his farmhouse" and mostly staying away from assembly and even public engagements since losing power in December 2023.

Vowing to "expose" the BRS, Reddy challenged KCR to attend the session for a debate on the Congress government's first 1,000 days in power and the 10-year rule of the previous BRS regime. Following a call given by him, the Congress activists held protests in the last few days demanding the resignation of KCR from the post of opposition leader for not attending the assembly.

At a recent public meeting, Reddy pointed out that the state spent Rs 1.24 crore on KCR's salary in the last 1,000 days and Rs 21 crores on his security, but



Telangana chief minister A Revanthi Reddy during a roadshow in Nalgonda district on Sunday.

unfulfilled poll promises, including pending dues of the tuition fees reimbursement scheme, the Rs five lakh 'bharama' card for students, scooters for girl students, and the merger of polytechnic with Young India Skills University, Ram Rao has said.

The BRS is preparing to attack the government on various issues such as the inclusion of lands on a large scale in the prohibitive list under Section 22A of the Registration Act, besides the unfulfilled promises of the ruling Congress during the assembly session.

In response to recent BJP-led protest in Delhi, Reddy said in July that the state would pass a resolution in assembly to reduce minimum age for becoming a candidate for Lok Sabha or Assembly election to 21 from 25.

T'gana min Prabhakar questions KCR over his absence from assembly

Press Trust of India

letters@hindustantimes.com

HYDERABAD: Slamming BRS president K Chandrashekar Rao for largely staying away from the Assembly, Telangana Transport Minister Ponnamp Rambhak on Sunday urged the former CM to attend the monsoon session beginning on Monday.

The ruling Congress organised a 'maha dharna' (mass protest) here, demanding resignation of Rao, popularly called KCR, for allegedly staying away from the Assembly while drawing a salary and other perks.

"Rao, who served as chief minister for 10 years, should have attended the House and presented his views as a responsible Leader of the Opposition. But he is missing public money by not attending the Assembly. Society is questioning this," Prabhakar claimed.

"If a government employee does not attend work, he is removed from service. People are now raising this question and Congress is taking up the

issue of the Opposition leadership and the 'dharna'," he added.

Highlighting the Congress government's welfare schemes, such as free travel for women in RTC buses, distribution of fine variety rice, the Indira Awaaz housing scheme for the poor and the filling of 72,000 government vacancies, he urged party workers to publicise the initiatives among the people.

Training his guns on the BPS, Prabhakar said the party should tell people what NDA government at the Centre did for Telangana. He alleged that the BRS and BJP were working together to defame Congress government.

State IT and Industries Minister D Sridhar Babu and several other Congress leaders addressed the 'maha dharna'.

Chief Minister A Revanthi Reddy had earlier criticised KCR for largely staying away from the Assembly, saying at a recent public meeting that the state had spent Rs 1.24 crore on his salary and Rs 21 crore on his security, but not on the facilities over the last 1,000 days.

'Total' map prepared for drugs-free India by 2029'

Gerard de Souza
gerard.desaouza@htlive.com

PANAJI: Union home minister Amit Shah on Sunday pledged that not a single gram of narcotics would either enter or leave India via its borders as he launched a roadmap for Nasha Mukti Bharat 2029, focused on supply reduction, demand reduction and harm reduction.



Amit Shah

to monitor it inch by inch," Shah said.

Shah, who was in Goa on an official trip, chaired a meeting to review the state's security preparedness before cancelling his events and rushing back to Delhi in the wake of a building collapse that has trapped and killed several people.

"We are caught between two regions which traditionally have been centres of narcotic production — the Red Crescent and the Red Triangle. One share comes from Myanmar and the other from Afghanistan. And on both sides the borders... the Myanmar border is open, we are setting it up now but both borders have such complex geography that it is not possible

to tackle drug networks."

"Before 2014, action against narcotics was done in bits and pieces and in isolated silos; the scope of action was limited to small seizures and small-time accused," he said. "After becoming home minister in 2019, I ensured that the fight against narcotics transitions from files and isolated actions by different agencies into a national, coordinated and continuous campaign."

He said that in 2019, a four-tier NCORD mechanism was created — apex, executive, state and district levels. "We integrated local police with the national strategy by forming dedicated anti-narcotics task forces in all states and union territories along with a joint coordination committee, so that central agencies and states take joint decisions on every major network, interstate links and operational gaps," he said.

Among the other changes were the launch of a national helpline for the rehabilitation of drug-addicted youth, increased

manpower and zonal presence, a national database of narco-offenders — "NIDAN" — and the initiation of integrated analysis via a data-driven map of networks, hotspots, transit open andi and drug-wise seizures through CCTNS data and integrated data fusion. Financial investigation and PIT-PNDS were made the core investigation standards, thereby simultaneously striking at hawala, benami properties, bank accounts and proceeds of crime, the home minister said.

In the last six years — 2020-2026 (till July) — over 29,968 kg of synthetic drugs, MSMDA, methamphetamine and mephedrone worth more than ₹19,600 crore were seized. From 2019 to 2026 (till July), a total of 9.33 million kg of narcotics and psychotropic substances were seized. From 2024 to June 2026, all enforcement agencies confiscated property worth ₹1,841 crore in 5,016 cases. "We seized the drugs along with their money," he added.

Sudhaya Kumar Sonu

J'KHAND MINISTER SUDHAYA KUMAR DIES OF CARDIAC ARREST AT AGE 56

Vishal Kant

letters@hindustantimes.com

RANCHI: Jharkhand higher education minister Sudhaya Kumar Sonu died of cardiac arrest at a private hospital in Giridih district on Sunday, people aware of the matter said. He was 56. The Hemant Soren-led government has declared a two-day state mourning following the death of senior Jharkhand Minister Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) leader. The two-term Giridih MLA had complained of discomfort at his residence before being rushed to the hospital, where he died during treatment around 4 am. "He was taken to a private hospital in Giridih but could not survive," a senior official said.

"Late at night, I received the heartbreaking news of the passing of my elder brother, our beloved Sudhaya Kumar Ji. Kumar was not just a senior colleague or political associate but a brother," Soren said.

Governor Gangwar said: "The news of the untimely demise of the Honorable State Minister, Shri Sudhaya Kumar, is deeply saddening and heart-wrenching. His passing is an irreparable loss to the state."

Bihar flood situation grim; 2.24 m hit

Subhash Pathak

subhash.pathak@htlive.com

PATNA: Floodwaters from the Ganga and its tributaries, including Purnpuri and Dardha, continued to wreak havoc in Patna and adjoining areas on Sunday, aggravated by heavy rains in their catchment zones in Bihar and neighbouring Jharkhand.

The Ganga crossed its previous highest flood level (HFL) at multiple points in the state capital. At Gandhi Ghat it stood at 50.77 metres this morning (0.05 metres above the August 2016 HFL). At Patna it was 43.32 metres (0.19 metres above the 2021 HFL), at Danapur 52.63 metres (0.02 metres above HFL), and at Banka Ghat 49.47 metres (0.03 metres above HFL). Downstream stations, including Hatidaha, remain under close watch, according to the water resources department and the disaster management department.

Several other rivers including the Gandak at Dumraighat and Hajipur, the Kosi at Balara and Buxa, the Bagmati at Buxa, the Ghaghara at Darauli, were flowing above danger marks.

According to the latest update, the rising waters have affected approximately 2.24 million people across 12 districts: Patna, Bhojpur, Saran, Vaishali, Bhagalpur, Begusar, Buxar, Samastipur, Munger, Katihar, Lakhisarai and Arwal — spanning 70 blocks and 368 gram panchayats.

Railway traffic disruption has been severe. Train traffic on the Patna-Gaya section has been completely snarled after Purn-



People waded through a flooded road following a rise in the water level of the Gandak river in Bihar's Hajipur on Sunday.

purn river water partially submerged the girder of the bridge near Purnpuri Ghat station. Local train services have been suspended; several express trains have been cancelled or diverted by east central railway (ECR). Embankment breaches compounded the crisis. In Patna's Masaurhi block, ring bunds and embankments gave way at Isar-chak, Vishwanathpur, Chand-chak, Chamarachak and Pauma under pressure from the Purnpuri and its tributaries (Dardha and Lokain). Linked to high releases from the Indrapuri barrage on the Sone and the swollen Gollan.

Relief operations have been scaled up. The DMED reported 190 community kitchens operating (up from about 80 a day earlier), serving roughly 25,000 meals so far. Twenty-seven SDRF teams and 15 NDRF teams remain deployed to districts. Meanwhile, medical camps have been set up. IED's Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, has demanded that the floods be declared a national disaster.

PH

BJP LEADER SMEARS MUD ON FACE OF PWD ENGG AMID FLOODING

RUDRAPUR: A BJP leader and his supporters allegedly smeared mud on the face of a public works department (PWD) assistant engineer and sufficed with him during an inspection of flood-hit areas in Bazpur of Uttarakhand's Udhampur Singh Nagar district on Sunday, accusing the PWD of delays in constructing bridges and embankments along the swollen Lelba River.

"Floodwater entered around 200 houses and we were on the spot to assess the situation and provide relief to the affected people. PWD officials reached the spot late, and local residents were extremely angry, which led to the incident," SDM Richa Singh said. Meanwhile, rain-induced landslides and boulder falls blocked over 130 roads across state, while the Banganga River in Haridwar marginally breached its danger mark of 231 metres and rising water levels in many rivers. Authorities are on alert over risk of landslides, flash floods and disruption to road connectivity.

PURE AND NOBLE LOVE IS BASIS OF OUR WORK, NOT HATRED: BHAGWAT

Agencies

letters@hindustantimes.com

LONDON: Rasthriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat on Sunday said pure and noble love is the foundation of the organisation's work, while rejecting claims that "intense hatred" forms the basis of its activities.

Speaking at an event in London, Bhagwat said a sense of oneness and belonging is central to Hindu thought and the RSS's approach. "I heard some people say, intense hatred is the basis of our work. It is just the reverse. Pure and noble love is the basis of our work," he said. He said the concept of "japann" (belongingness) extends from the individual to family, community, society and nation, while also espousing the Hindu civilisational connection with nature.

"So, a Hindu is not an individual; he is family, as well as his society, as well as his society, as well as humanity. And, as all of us know, Hindus, they love nature. Not only worship, they love nature," he said.

Bhagwat said this sense of belonging and love forms the basis of unity and "character of Hinduism has remained central to the RSS even after 100 years." "And that has not changed, it is worn out even today,"

'Outreach campaign': Oppn takes swipe at Modi's SRCC speech

Himanshi Sharma

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi's speech at Sri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC) has sparked political reactions, with the Opposition calling it an "outreach" campaign that only comes when people become "out of reach." The Opposition also criticised the PM's description of critics as "angry uncles."

Addressing students at SRCC to mark the college's centenary on Saturday, Modi said: "Outside this campus, you will find a new world. You will find all types of people. The first type of people who positively transform the power of society into the power of the nation, and the other who would question every development project or growth policy like 'naraz fula' (angry uncle)."

"But India gave a befitting reply to such uncles," he added. Reacting to Modi's statements, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said: "It was an opportunity for dialogue on the country's youth, and their future. But instead of facing the youth's questions, the (PM's) speech turned into yet another political campaign." Kharge further said that Modi's "Modi's Outreach" and "his way of giving new adjectives to people."

"Adjectives keep changing, but the Modi government's anti-people policies do not change." Modi's outreach is only needed when you become out of reach," he added.



Narendra Modi

Rajya Sabha MP and senior advocate Kailash Satish Mehta said that the PM's speech was not different. "We will write your report card, you (Modi) can't do it on your own," he said. He also added that unemployment among youth has risen.

"In this very quarter where you are celebrating 7.8% growth, 15.9% of people between the ages of 15 and 29 do not have work. In cities, that figure is 18.2%, and among women it is 25%." He added that graduate unemployment under the age of 25 stood at 38% up from 35% in 2018, and said manufacturing's share of employment had fallen from over 17% in the previous government's tenure to around 12% now. "These are figures, Modi ji, not a speech," he said.

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leaders defended the PM's speech, saying it was meant to motivate students rather than target rivals.

NAGA ANCESTRAL REMAINS TO COME BACK FROM UK

Alice Thoshy

letters@hindustantimes.com

KOHIMA: The University of Oxford Council has approved the repatriation of 39 Naga ancestral human remains held at the Pitt Rivers Museum (PRM) in the United Kingdom.

The repatriation is expected to be completed by the end of this year and the initiative was started jointly by the Forum for Naga Reconciliation (FNR) and its Recoverer Rest and Decolonise (RRAD), along with Naga tribe bodies.

In a letter to FNR convenor Wati Arai, PRM director Laura Van Broekhoven conveyed that the University's Council had on 22 July formally agreed to return 39 human remains while declining the repatriation of one set as it does not have clear evidence that it was of Naga origin. The letter expressed hope that work can now commence towards bringing the Naga ancestors to their homeland.

"The path home for the Naga ancestors has now become a reality as they journey to the Naga homeland. It is an essential step of a longer journey towards justice and dignity, and towards healing and wholeness," read a joint statement of the FNR-RRAD and Naga tribe bodies.

Punjab cabinet opposes HC chief justice appointment; says consent not obtained

HT Correspondents

letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH/ALANDHAR: The Punjab government on Sunday opposed the appointment of Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra as the Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court.

The Punjab government said the appointment of Justice Mishra should be put on hold until the state government's views are obtained and duly considered.

The Centre had notified the appointment on Saturday, nearly a month after the Supreme Court Collegium's recommendation.

In an urgent meeting via video-conference, the Punjab cabinet condemned the Centre for bypassing the established procedure and ignoring the state's



Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra

constitutional rights, alleging that the appointment was made without the state's consent.

"The Memorandum of Procedure for appointment and transfer of chief justices and judges of high court," in its Para 6, clearly indicates that no receipt of recommendation of the Chief Justice of India, the Union minister of law, justice and company

affairs would obtain the views of the state government concerned. After receipt of the views of the state government, the Union minister will submit proposals to the Prime Minister, who will then advise the President as to the selection," the cabinet said.

After chairing the meeting, Manoj in a post on X, stated: "Today, the Punjab cabinet unanimously passed an important resolution against the continued assault on state's rights by the central government and the violation of constitutional norms. Appointing the new chief justice of the Punjab and Haryana high court without obtaining the consent of the state government is a direct violation of the prescribed procedures

(Memorandum of Procedure) and constitutional norms."

"We demand that this appointment be immediately put on hold until the consent of the Punjab cabinet is obtained. The views of the state be accorded due respect," he added.

Reacting to the notification, the Punjab cabinet further stated that in complete disregard to the memorandum of procedures and established Constitutional norms, the Union government hurriedly notified the appointment without availing respect of the state government. It said no clear time limit was prescribed for the state and the governor to send its recommendation in the case of appointment of the chief justice.

SC orders SITs to probe into fraud motor accident claims

Utmarsh Andand

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has ordered every state and union territory to constitute a special investigation team (SIT) to crack down on fraudulent motor accident compensation claims involving insurance companies that their top management will be held accountable if suspicious claims are selectively withheld from investigators.

The bench of justices Abhmalind Anand and Prashant B. Varale expanded the scrutiny from individual claims in Odisha and Tamil Nadu to a nationwide exercise, bringing the insurance regulator, the Union finance ministry, the road transport ministry and the General Insurance Council within the ambit of its proceedings.

The bench further asked the states to disclose the procedure adopted by them for investigating such fraudulent claims. "Use of computer made it clear that the responsibility does not rest



The matter will be taken up next on September 23.

a vehicle shown in a compensation claim was actually involved in the accident.

The case arose from an appeal by Oriental Insurance Company against a compensation order in an Odisha case. The insurer had alleged that the vehicle had been shown as the offending vehicle in a fraudulent claim, but had sold insurance, despite being involved in multiple accidents.

The court's February order recorded that an investigation ordered in Odisha had found the vehicle was indeed involved in the accident in the case before it. But the probe also found that the same vehicle figured in four other fraudulent claims. More significantly, the Odisha authorities told the court that they had found a "wide racket" in which several stakeholders could be involved and that arrests had already taken place. The revelations prompted the bench to look beyond the individual case, highlighting delays and vacancies in Odisha, through their directors general of Police. In the proceedings, asking Odisha to place before the other states its model investigation process.

The matter will next come up on September 23, when the states, insurance companies and newly formed authorities are expected to submit a report on steps being taken in this regard.

Pankaj S Raut

letters@hindustantimes.com

PALGHAR: At least 17 people, mostly Shiv Sena functionaries, were booked on Sunday for allegedly abusing, assaulting and threatening the staff at a private hospital in Maharashtra's Palghar district after a dispute over the discharge of injured Govindas (Dahi Handi) participants and medical bills, officials familiar with the matter said.

According to officials, the incident took place at around 11.5 am at Relief Hospital in Palghar, where five Govindas injured while attempting to break a Dahi Handi organised by Shiv Sena and UTS, through their directors general of Police. In the proceedings, asking Odisha to place before the other states its model investigation process.

{ MAHARASHTRA CASE PENDING FOR 32 YEARS }

Consumer forums face huge backlog: Report

Abraham Thomas

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A 32-year-old consumer dispute in Maharashtra has emerged as the oldest case pending before a state consumer commission, according to a report submitted to the Supreme Court, highlighting delays and vacancies across consumer forums.

The report, prepared by lawyers assisting the court as amicus curiae, identified a 30-year-old case from Kerala and one from Rajasthan. It also found in Jammu & Kashmir, West Bengal and Assam, while Goa, Bihar, Tamil Nadu, Telangana and

Rajasthan have cases pending for over 15 years.

A separate report by National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (NCDRC) president Justice AP Sahai said three vacancies remain unfilled at the commission, while two members continue on extension. The president said the commission had handled around 18,767 cases as of July 31.

The reports were filed in a suo motu case on reforms in consumer courts. A bench headed by Chief Justice of India, N. Chandrabudh, along with Justices Jayashree Agh and V Mohana, on September 2 directed the Centre to consider Justice Sahai's report and take immediate remedial measures. States and Union Territories were

also asked to respond to the amicus report by October 1.

State Commissions

The amicus report, based on responses from 26 states and UTs, found total pendency of 1,13,276 cases. Maharashtra had the highest case load at 34,203, followed by Uttar Pradesh (15,675), Karnataka (9,244), Haryana (8,719) and Gujarat (6,414).

Nearly half the cases before state commissions take more than a year to decide. In Karnataka, decisions in 460 cases had not been uploaded for six months. Maharashtra had 800 such orders across two benches, while 70 cases in West Bengal remained pending for months.

RAJ: NURSING STAFF HELD FOR MOLESTING PATIENT IN HOSPITAL

JAIPOUR: A nursing staff member at a private hospital in Jaipur has been arrested for allegedly molesting a woman while she was undergoing treatment, police said on Sunday. According to a complaint lodged by the woman's father, she developed stomach pain on Friday afternoon and was admitted to the hospital.

The complainant alleged that the nursing staff member administered a sedative while putting her on an intravenous drip that night, following which she lost consciousness. After regaining consciousness the next morning, she suspected that she had been sexually assaulted. The woman told her family that the accused also threatened her when she protested.

District Commissions

Only 598 of 632 district commissions responded to the questionnaire. Uttar Pradesh had 13 cases dating to 1999-2000 and 40 from 2009-10 still pending. Bihar had one case pending for nearly three decades, while Kerala and Jharkhand each had one case in the 30-year-old bracket.

Vacancy Position

Madhya Pradesh's three state commission benches have no President. Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Jharkhand have no members, while Uttar Pradesh and Karnataka face 87% vacancies and Bihar 75%. Seven other state commissions, including Delhi, have 50% vacancies.

Gen-Z movement hijacked by many parties: Mayawati

LUCKNOW: BSP chief Mayawati on Sunday said the Gen-Z movement had been "hijacked" by political parties and directed towards the issues peacefully. She said BSP members should not hold protests but conserve resources for elections.

1st international film festival in J&K to start today

SRINAGAR: The First International Film Festival of Jammu and Kashmir, which commenced in Srinagar from Monday, The four-day film festival will witness screening of 135 films, short films and documentaries from over 40 countries.

Poco undertrial dies in Odisha jail, family cries foul

BHUBANESHWAR: A 31-year-old undertrial prisoner accused in a POCSO case died at Paralakshmedhi Sub-Jail in Odisha's Jagajapati district, police said, with his family alleging foul play in his death. Ruma Badarait was shifted to hospital after complaining of chest pain on Saturday, but doctors declared him dead, officials said. "We demand a high-level probe," a relative said.

Urban roads don't connect

India's cities need more connections, not just more roads

Shivani Singh

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Google Maps says it will take 30 minutes to drive to a place that is barely 10 minutes away from the city. The reason is often not the distance, but the road network: the direct route simply does not exist.

A missing link, dead-end street or large gated block can push traffic onto a busy arterial, where a single breakdown or minor accident can quickly create a gridlock. This is the paradox of India's growing cities. Governments widen roads, build flyovers and elevated corridors, yet congestion returns. More road capacity attracts more traffic, while neighbourhood streets remain poorly connected.

But what if cities are building roads in the wrong places? The problem, urban planners and mobility experts say, is not simply a shortage of roads. It is a shortage of connected roads.

A well-functioning network needs a hierarchy: arterials wider than 35 metres for longer-distance movement; sub-arterials of 20-35 metres connecting neighbourhoods; collector roads of 12-20 metres for local traffic; and streets narrower than 10 metres providing direct access to homes and amenities.

Without these layers connected, traffic has multiple routes, but access more neighbourhoods directly and quickly, and pedestrians can reach public transit stops without long detours. But much of India's urban road network does not work this way.

The missing middle

A WRI India report released on August 11 found that secondary roads—those between 10 and 35 metres wide—are increasingly scarce in several major cities.

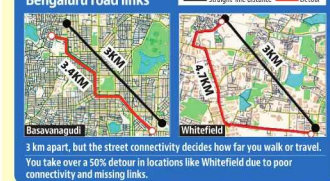
They account for just 3.7% of total road length in Hyderabad, 6% in Kolkata, 7% in Delhi, 7.4% in Chennai and 7.7% in Bengaluru. In Mumbai, Ahmedabad and Pune, secondary roads account for 12%, 12.5% and 13% respectively.

But road length alone does not tell the full story. Location and configuration matter. In Bengaluru, secondary roads are relatively uniform across the city, while in Mumbai and Pune, they are concentrated in peripheral areas, says Pawan Mukulika, executive programme director at WRI India.

India's lopsided roads



Bengaluru road links



In Bengaluru's Whitefield, travelling between two points three kilometres apart requires a 4.7-kilometre drive, with a 1,700-metre detour. In Basavanagudi, the detour is only about 400 metres. WRI analysis shows that the contrast reflects planning: Whitefield, despite being a major IT hub developed with enough connecting streets, however, Basavanagudi, one of the old city neighbourhoods, has an established road network.

When roads go nowhere

Bengaluru's problem is not just narrow roads; some newer roads are wide, but fail to connect.

Urban expert Ashwin Mahesh cites one such missing link. A 60-foot road near his home in Puttenahalli dead-ends on one side and narrows to 30 feet on the other. Developers may build wide roads that are later handed to the municipality, but if adjoining links are not completed, those roads become bottlenecks rather than solutions.

He also points to the problem in Bannerghatta station, which narrows from more than 100 feet to less than half its width before reaching a highway, pushing traffic into residential areas.

Bengaluru and Delhi have similar connectivity scores in WRI's analysis—0.44 and 0.46. Yet Bengaluru has a higher dead-end rate: 0.25 compared with Delhi's 0.18. Rapid peripheral growth has compounded the problem. High-rises gated communities, malls and office campuses have transformed the tech corridor, but development has outpaced the supporting street network.

The superblock problem

The problem is even more visible on foot.

Mobility expert Shreya Gadepalli says urban blocks ideally should not exceed one hectare. A street every 100 metres, common in older Indian neighbourhoods, creates multiple routes for the fewest detours to a destination. The detour should ideally not be more than 50% of the as-the-crow-flies distance.

Modern planning has moved towards larger "mega-blocks" of roughly one square kilometre, particularly since the 1960s in Delhi and the 1990s elsewhere.

Gated developments can make matters worse. In Gurgaon, Gadepalli recalls, a bus stop 250 metres away in a straight line required a 1.7-kilometre walk. The detour was no direct route. That matters for public transport. Gadepalli says a 300-metre walk can encourage use, while a 600-metre or longer walk deters use of public transport.

Sarojini Jain in Delhi, built in the 1950s, illustrates the older approach. Its low-rise street grid

and porous access allowed easy movement between buildings. Redevelopment is now replacing parts of that pattern with larger, walled and gated complexes, Gadepalli says.

The result can be a city where a metro station or bus stop is nearby, but effectively inaccessible on foot, compelling people to switch to private vehicles. This is especially problematic for Indian cities already facing a severe mobility crisis and poor air quality.

Land is the hard part

Why not simply build the missing links?

The answer is often land. Acquiring parcels through built-up neighbourhoods is expensive, politically difficult and time-consuming. "The main barrier to connecting roads in cities is difficulty in finding land to build on," says Mahesh Pai, CEO of WRI India.

But Delhi and Ahmedabad show how institutional mechanisms can help.

Delhi's early master planning involved large-scale land acquisition by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA), making it easier to establish street grids. Under the new master plan, the authority is now working on a comprehensive grid for new neighbourhoods and its land-pooling policy. Private landowners will be combining land parcels to build properties and cede portions to DDA, which would build the trunk infrastructure.

Ahmedabad's town-planning scheme similarly facilitates land acquisition for roads and amenities. Combined with mixed land use, this has helped keep average trip lengths relatively short, says Pai. The intensity of travel demand is lower in Ahmedabad than in other Tier-1 cities. It also has multiple modes of public transport, such as buses, BRT, and the Metro, which place relatively less pressure on the road network, adds Mukulika.

Mumbai has the highest share of secondary roads among the tier-1 cities studied by WRI—35%. The city has systematically augmented its road network while undertaking redevelopment of existing areas, says Pai. Projects such as the Santa Cruz-Chembur and Jogeshwari-Vikhroli link roads have strengthened connections.

Yet, Mumbai's road density is only 0.46, compared with 0.91 in Delhi and 1.21 in Bengaluru. Its connectivity value is also lower than Delhi's 0.65 and Bengaluru's 0.66. For Mumbai, the priority should be to connect fragmented roads and eliminate dead ends, rather than simply adding capacity, says Mukulika.

Pune's work in progress

Cities must address legacy issues before they start new projects. In Pune, the 700 km of roads proposed in the city's 1997 development plan remain unfinished. Land acquisition issues, funding constraints, public resistance, and poor planning have left crucial connections incomplete. But Pune's problem is not confined

to the periphery. Many roads in the core areas, which are 24-36 metres wide, and even established ones like Baner-Pashan, have missing links.

Civic body chief Naval Kishore Ram says the administration is now focused on completing all these projects. As many as 33 critical links that impede traffic have been identified. 12 have been prioritised, with funds for land acquisition allocated by the state government. Work has begun on five, and the administration aims to complete the 12 within a Sunday for culpable homicide not amounting to murder, while 10 of them were arrested.

Chief minister Mohan Yadav led the incident "tragic and unfortunate" and ordered strict action. "I have directed the minister-in-charge and officials to conduct an immediate inquiry. No one found guilty in this matter will be spared," he said.

Meanwhile, health minister and deputy chief minister Rajendra Shukla reached Sagur to investigate the matter. On the CM's directions, Deputy Commissioner Neeraj Srivastava was transferred to Gwalior headquarters, while three excise officials — assistant commissioner Kiran Dubey, assistant district excise officer Dilip Khanate, and sub-inspector Roshni Unet — were suspended. Superintendent of police Anand Sujan suspended Gurgaon in-charge Purnan Lal and Banda police station in-charge Rajendra Singh.

Chief minister and health officer Devesh Pateriya confirmed methyl alcohol poisoning as the cause of the deaths.

Poorly connected networks slow down emergency services and public transport connections are maintained.

Connect the gaps

The solution differs between new and established neighbourhoods. For greenfield developments, land pooling and integrating road construction with urban development can ensure that the street network grows alongside housing and commercial projects.

In built-up areas, acquiring land for missing links is harder. Gadepalli suggests Transferable Development Rights (TDR) to compensate landowners who surrender land for public cut-throughs.

With much of India's infrastructure for 2047-50 still to be built, the need to repeat the cycle of widening roads, building flyovers, or invest in the more important task of connecting neighbourhoods. The most useful road network is one that can turn a 30-minute journey into a 10-minute one.

11 killed in MP hooch tragedy

Shruti Tomar and Anupam Pateriya

letters@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL/SAGUR: Eleven people died, and 94 fell ill after consuming spurious liquor in Madhya Pradesh's Sagur district on the intervening night of Saturday and Sunday, police said.

Police added that 20 people from Sagur and Uttar Pradesh's Lalitpur, suspected of supplying the hooch, were booked on Sunday for culpable homicide not amounting to murder, while 10 of them were arrested.

Chief minister Mohan Yadav led the incident "tragic and unfortunate" and ordered strict action. "I have directed the minister-in-charge and officials to conduct an immediate inquiry. No one found guilty in this matter will be spared," he said.

Meanwhile, health minister and deputy chief minister Rajendra Shukla reached Sagur to investigate the matter. On the CM's directions, Deputy Commissioner Neeraj Srivastava was transferred to Gwalior headquarters, while three excise officials — assistant commissioner Kiran Dubey, assistant district excise officer Dilip Khanate, and sub-inspector Roshni Unet — were suspended. Superintendent of police Anand Sujan suspended Gurgaon in-charge Purnan Lal and Banda police station in-charge Rajendra Singh.

Chief minister and health officer Devesh Pateriya confirmed methyl alcohol poisoning as the cause of the deaths.



Around 94 people are receiving treatment at the government hospital in Sagur district after consuming spurious liquor.

Patients are coming from three to four villages. One man was airlifted to AIIMS Bhopal in serious condition. The cause of death is methyl alcohol poisoning, but we are waiting for the detailed autopsy report," he said.

District collector Pratibha Patil met affected families, reviewed hospital care, and appealed to villagers with symptoms of vomiting, headache, or fever to seek immediate medical attention.

Police arrested 10 men accused of supplying spurious liquor from Lalitpur and Sagur, said SP Sujana. "A case was registered against 20 people, and investigation is underway."

Excise teams seized bottles for forensic testing. Preliminary investigations revealed a racket in Lalitpur manufacturing spurious liquor, packaging it with counterfeit labels, caps, and QR codes, and supplying it at low prices to Subsequent to the agencies concerned the network and sending samples for examination," SP Sujana said.

Well found at razed UP mosque; ASI to probe

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

MEERUT: Authorities in Uttar Pradesh's Saharanpur on Sunday halted debris-clearance work around a demolished illegal mosque in the collectorate premises after a brick-lined well was found at the site.

Officials stated that the debris clearance work on hold until a technical investigation team, including the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI), will examine the well on Sunday and historical significance.

The mosque in the Saharanpur collectorate premises was demolished on Saturday in connection with the September 2 court order that upheld the city magistrate's court order on July 16, which had declared the mosque illegal and directed its demolition. However, security was deployed at the collectorate during the operation.

Subodh Kumar, the subdivisional magistrate (Sadar), confirmed the discovery of the well and said, "This action (demolition) was carried out by us in compliance with a court order. A well has been discovered here. These achievements are a matter of immense pride and a powerful affirmation of the potential of the tribal students."

The rise in the number of EMRS students qualifying NEET-UG shows what becomes possible when talent is supported with quality education, a nurturing residential environment and the right academic resources," she said.

The secretary further said that the ministry's endeavour was not merely to help students clear competitive examinations, but to expand their horizons and enable them to pursue their aspirations in professional fields.

We remain committed to strengthening these pathways so that every deserving tribal student can dream big and realise their potential. NEEST is also building Centres of Excellence for JEE and NEET preparation, with more than 500 EMRS students currently enrolled in the programme. Online coaching for the two competitive examinations has also been extended across various EMRS.

The support can continue after the entrance examination. Eligible ST students admitted to identified premier institutions can avail themselves of the ministry's support through the National Scholarship Scheme for Top Class Education, which covers higher education at 265 identified premier institutions offering UG, PG, and research programmes in various fields.

The highest NEET score among EMRS students this year was recorded by Raviha Bhargava, Managing of EMRS Vejpur in Gujarat, who scored 531 out of 720.

The larger test for EMRS, however, will be whether this year's improvement is a trend rather than a one-off.

MANIPUR RECORDS 1.96 MN NAMES IN FINAL VOTER LIST

Thomas Ngangom

letters@hindustantimes.com

IMPHAL: The Election Commission of India on Sunday released the final electoral roll after a special internet revision (SIR) in 2024 following the census in Manipur, with the state recording 1.96 million electors, according to a press note issued by the state's chief electoral officer. According to the press note, there has been an increase of 26,221 electors over the draft roll published on July 5, 2026, which had 1,934,389 electors. During the revision process, 56,871 electors were added while 30,650 were deleted from the draft electoral roll, the note added.

This comes amid the growing demand for updated National Register of Citizens (NRC) before the census. The final photo electoral roll has recorded a total of 1,960,620 voters with 953,350 male, 1,006,962 female and 308 third gender persons. A total of 1,221,833 notices were issued during the verification phase. Following hearings and examination of documents, 26,362 electors from the draft roll were marked ineligible.

2 UKNA cadre neutralised in Manipur

IMPHAL: Security forces killed two cadres of the banned United Kuki National Army (UKNA) and injured two others during an operation in Churachandpur district, officials said. Forces also recovered arms and ammunition were from the camp.

The operation followed intelligence inputs and began with surveillance of a UKNA camp in Phabong village on August 29. The exchange of fire began on September 2, officials said.

Lankesh murder accused fetes B'uru police commissioner

BENGALURU: An accused in the Gauri Lankesh murder case and an NDPS case accused were feted by police commissioner, who was photographed felicitating newly appointed Hubballi-Dharwad Police Commissioner Bhushan Borase, raising questions over their access to his office. Borase said over 200 people had met him since he assumed charge in Hubballi and he did not personally know everyone.

Assam police jawan trampled to death by wild elephant

SILCHAR: A 50-year-old Assam Police Task Force jawan was trampled to death by a wild elephant near a sand-laden dumpsite after an accidental encounter with the tusker during night patrolling in Assam's Goalpara district, police said on Sunday. The incident took place around 1:30 am when seven APTF personnel were on night patrol. However, six of them managed to escape the attack.

3-month-old among 6 killed in UP accident

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

LUCKNOW: Six people, including a three-month-old infant, were killed and five others injured after a sand-laden dumper rained a tempo on the Agra-Moradabad National Highway in Uttar Pradesh's Sambhal district on Sunday, police said.

The accident took place around 9 am near Bannetta village, nearly 2 km from the district headquarters, under Bahjoi police station limits.

The deceased had been identified as three-month-old Aaradhya, her eight-year-old brother Dhruv, their 20-year-old maternal aunt Rohini, tempo driver Sauran Pal, 40, his associate Ruvaad, 30, and Rampal, Circle Officer (Bahjoi) Stuti Singh said. All six were travelling in the tempo.

The collision badly damaged the tempo.

The dumper that rained into a tempo in UP's Sambhal.

The front portion of the tempo, trapping its driver inside, the dumper went out of control after the crash, hit a roadside tree and overturned.

Sambhal superintendent of police (SP) Vikas Chandra Tripathi said the tempo was travelling in its lane when an e-rickshaw ahead suddenly took a U-turn. The dumper, approaching from the opposite direction, allegedly swerved to avoid the e-rickshaw before crashing into the tempo, he added.

The crash against the tree, the front portion of the tempo, trapping its driver inside, the dumper went out of control after the crash, hit a roadside tree and overturned.

The collision badly damaged the tempo.

Sanjeev K Jha

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A newspaper clipping about a four-year-old accident victim inspired a teenager to dream of becoming a surgeon. Another stayed back at her residential school through the pandemic to prepare for the medical entrance test.

This year, those aspirations translated into medical college seats as 436 students from Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS) cleared the NEET-UG 2026, as compared to the 344 last year — a 26.7% increase—revealed data from the National Education Survey for Tribal Students (NESTS). In 2024, the figure was 6, while in 2023, one of the EMRS students could qualify for NEET-UG.

At least 27 of the successful candidates have already secured medical college seats. With counselling still underway, officials expect the number of admissions to increase.

EMRS were conceived as residential schools for students belonging to Scheduled Tribe (ST) and Scheduled Caste (SC) communities, where geography, household circumstances and limited access to specialised academic resources make the school professional education particularly difficult.

Gujarati produced the most qualifiers, with 117 students following by Chhattisgarh with 50, Madhya Pradesh with 65, Odisha with 36 and Telangana with 32, making the improvement a state-specific phenomenon.

Among those who have already crossed the next hurdle is Bijay Kisku of EMRS Bangpur, Odisha, who has secured admission to AIIMS Raipur. In Chhattisgarh, two students of EMRS Kosambada from the Khamar community — a PVTG — have also secured medical college admissions. Namrata has



EMRS students Namrata Kumar and Bijay Kisku.

secured a seat at P.J.N.M. Medical College, Raipur, while Nakeshwar Ram has secured admission to Government Medical College, Mahasamund.

Nakeshwar's father is a farmer and his mother a homemaker. An uncle who was a teacher encouraged him to join EMRS. The school's residential and relatively distraction-free environment allowed him to devote hours to preparation, including self-study in the hostel. "A friend showed me a video about a four-year-old girl from Bilaspur who survived a serious accident after a surgeon operated on her. The account made me realise the importance of the role of surgeons and strengthened my determination to enter medicine," he said.

Namrata's story highlights a different barrier: information. She decided by Class 9 that she wanted to become a doctor, but her family had limited awareness of NEET. "My principal helped guide me through the NEET preparation process. After my Class 10 board examinations, I stayed at the school during the vacation to prepare for NEET. I studied for 12 hours and continuing late into the night at the hostel," she said, adding that the school's infrastructure played an important supporting role.

Students used libraries, digital-board lessons, online learning resources and computer-based mock tests. The emphasis is increasingly shifting from merely teaching the curriculum

{ HIGH-DECIBEL CELEBRATIONS }

Pune festival noise battle wins wide support

Shrinivas Deshpande, Hezri Anthony and Pradip Kumar Maitra

letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI/PUNE/NAGPUR: As a citizen-led agitation against festive noise pollution picks up momentum in Maharashtra's Pune, the Indian Medical Association (IMA) has also urged organisers to exercise restraint during all festivities and warned citizens to exercise caution against excessive exposure to loud DJs and intense laser lights.

While the IMA regularly takes a strong stand against crackers and laser lights, this time it has specifically urged against the use of loud DJs and laser lights. The Pune battle picked up after Pune-based anti-noise pollution activist Vidyanand Bapat was assaulted by a



In Pune, Ganesh mandals are opting for traditional dhoolas over DJ systems.

Pune police commissioner Amitesh Kumar had directed mandals to restrict sound systems to four bass and four top speakers and to not use plasma speakers and laser lights.

For the first time, over 100 police personnel were deployed with decibel meters and rangefinders to monitor noise levels at 100 locations. "Most areas were quieter, but we will analyse the readings and take action against violations," said Prashant Annurkar, deputy commissioner of police (Special Branch).

The administration's approach also found political support in Mehina Sakore-Bordikar, BJP MLA and minister of state. Last year, I lost my cousin due to loud noise. Loudspeakers are troublesome to many, and there have to be curbs on them," she said. CM Devendra Fadnis

too has called for control over excessive DJ noise and advocated a return to traditional forms of celebration.

The crack against noise pollution is spreading across Maharashtra, with different regions adopting their own methods. In Solapur, a phased reduction in sound systems is being effected rather than an overnight ban.

Sangli permitted mandals one top and one bass speaker during the festival. The crack against noise pollution has been registered across the district last year, while none had been reported during this year's Dahi Handi celebrations. In Nagpur, a day-long standoff between police and event organisers over playing DJ music ended late on Friday when the music resumed but without the throbbing bass sound.

[CORPS COMMANDERS-LEVEL TALKS]

India, China at border talks in Arunachal sector

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Indian and Chinese commanders-level talks at the Wacha-Damai border point in Arunachal Pradesh's Kibithoo sector, days after the two countries held the 25th round of talks between their special representatives on the boundary issue in Beijing.

The military talks focussed on issues along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in the eastern sector, including maintaining peace and tranquillity along the border, people aware of the matter said.

Lieutenant General Girish Kalra, who heads the Dimaapur 3 Corps, led the Indian side. The Army did not comment on the development.

THE MEETING WAS HELD AT THE WACHA-DAMAI BORDER POINT IN ARUNACHAL PRADESH'S KIBITHOO SECTOR

The meeting was the first corps commander-level engagement in the sector since the special representatives' talks. Two additional rounds for holding the senior highest military commander meeting (SHMC—corps commander level) to improve border management measures were among the eight points of outcome and consensus reached during the talks in Beijing.

Sunday's meeting was also the

first since tensions reportedly erupted between the Indian Army and the Chinese People's Liberation Army (PLA) in Taksin, a remote area of Arunachal Pradesh's Upper Subansiri district.

On August 25, India emphasised that peace and tranquillity along the border with China are essential for the overall development of bilateral relations, as National Security Advisor Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, the special representatives of the two countries, met in Beijing to discuss boundary delimitation and trans-boundary cooperation.

According to a readout from the external affairs ministry, the Indian side 'highlighted the importance of maintaining peace and tranquillity in the India-China border areas for the con-

tinued development and progress of the bilateral relationship.'

The status of the standoff reported in the Arunachal Pradesh sector is unclear. However, people familiar with the situation had earlier said there were a few face-offs between Indian and Chinese troops in the Taksin area and that matters became more serious towards the end of July.

The latest military engagement comes amid efforts by India and China to stabilise ties following the military confrontation in eastern Ladakh in 2020. The meeting of the special representatives in Beijing was their third since the two countries reached an understanding in October 2024 to end the Ladakh standoff, which had taken bilateral ties to their lowest point since the 1962 border war.

Decoding economic drivers of Gen Z protests, jobs debate

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: This summer, thousands of young Indians took to the streets to demand sweeping reforms of the higher education sector. This unexpected wave of Gen Z mobilisation was catalysed by the emergence of the Cockerroach Janta party (CJP), a satirical meme page that blossomed into a national movement. Protests that began over the state of higher education soon tapped into something much larger: growing frustration among young Indians over jobs, economic opportunity, and their prospects for the future.

India's jobs debate is often framed around a familiar set of concerns: too many people working in agriculture, too few in manufacturing jobs, an economy that is too services-oriented, and stubbornly high unemployment among the young. But not all of these truisms about the Indian economy are actually borne out by the data, argues economist Vijay Mahabare.

Mahabare elaborated on her views on the season premiere of Grand Tamasha, a weekly podcast on Indian politics and policy co-produced by HT and the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. Mahabare is the Union Bank Chair Professor of Economics and Director at the Great Lakes Institute of Management in Chennai. She studies central banking and monetary policy, structural transformation, labour market dynamics and gender economics.

Mahabare spoke with Grand Tamasha host Milan

MAHABARE HIGHLIGHTED THE FACT THAT, IN INDIA, IT IS THE RICHEST STATES THAT HAVE THE HIGHEST RATES OF YOUTH UNEMPLOYMENT

Vaishnav about the economic drivers of the Gen Z protests, the link between unemployment and education, and the futility of the manufacturing versus services debate. She also discussed the exodus of young people from the agricultural sector, the misleading headlines on female labour force participation, and India's acute urban housing shortage.

Mahabare highlighted the fact that, in India, it is the India's richest states that have the highest rates of youth unemployment. "In prosperous states like Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Telangana, unemployment among young people is high, which seems counter-intuitive. In these states, education levels are higher, and more men and women are looking for jobs, unless, of course, the labour force is simply larger. Second, educated people want a specific kind of job, so they wait for it. To wait, you need a kind of privilege," she explained. "In poorer states, unemployment is low, but it's because fewer people, especially women, are looking for work. Men there can't wait long whatever job comes up, they have to take it quickly because there's no family support."

The economist also took issue with the oft-repeated

claim that India needs to get more young people out of agriculture. "If we look at people in the age group of 20 to 29, currently only 15% of young adults in India are working in agriculture. Twenty years back, that number was 34%," she stated.

"Structural transformation among today's young has already taken place. The median age of agricultural labour is 53 in Kerala, 48 in Tamil Nadu, and 40 in all of India. If we push for more people to leave, it will be to think about people who go."

Mahabare said the time is ripe to think about how "we discuss agriculture as an industry, an occupation, and how we help raise incomes within it rather than talking as if the transformation hasn't happened, because among the young it's nearly complete."

Looking ahead, she identified the absence of a manufacturing base in northern states as a key economic challenge.

"Manufacturing in India is concentrated in the four or five most prosperous states that produce around 60% of total manufacturing output," she cautioned. "To flourish, manufacturing has to move to the northern states. In the south, young people are educated now and don't want factory-floor jobs, unless, of course, the labour force is simply larger. Second, educated people want a specific kind of job, so they wait for it. To wait, you need a kind of privilege," she explained. "In poorer states, unemployment is low, but it's because fewer people, especially women, are looking for work. Men there can't wait long whatever job comes up, they have to take it quickly because there's no family support."

The economist also took issue with the oft-repeated

[MAHADEV BETTING CASE ACCUSED]

IAE claim may delay India's extradition bid

Neeral Chaudhan
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's attempt to extradite Sourabh Chandrakar, the mastermind of the 60,000-crore Mahadev online gambling racket, from Oman has hit a hurdle. Agencies in India have learned that the UAE has also sent an extradition request to Oman seeking his transfer, people familiar with the development said.

This, officials said, means that even if India wins the extradition case in Oman—which may take months or even years—the timeline to bring him back to India will be affected as New Delhi will have to wait for Oman's decision on the UAE's request.

Both the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the Enforcement Directorate (ED) are pursuing Chandrakar's extradition since the Royal Oman Police detained him in Muscat last week of June based on an intercepted notice. He had been in the UAE, where he was hiding since 2019, to Oman sometime in April this year using a false passport, according to officials.

"We have learnt that the UAE authorities have also sent an extradition request for Chandrakar to Oman on some

AGENCIES IN INDIA HAVE LEARNED THAT THE UAE HAS ALSO SENT AN EXTRADITION REQUEST TO OMAN SEEKING TRANSFER OF CHANDRAKAR

unknown charges, which we don't know about. We are in regular touch with Oman authorities through diplomatic channels but this latest development has the potential to delay our attempts to get him sooner," said an official, requesting anonymity.

Officials hinted that Chandrakar might have, through his aides, registered a false case against himself in the UAE, which is now cited in Abu Dhabi's extradition request.

After he fled to Dubai, extradition requests sent by India to the UAE authorities did not fructify. He was, in fact, detained in Dubai in 2024 but was subsequently released.

Chandrakar, who is believed to be in his early 30s, set up the Mahadev betting empire along with co-founder Ravi Uppal. Uppal went missing from the

UAE sometime in November 2025 and reportedly fled to Vanuatu.

Their illegal betting operations, still running across India despite the government banning multiple platforms and apps linked to Mahadev, allow people to place illegal bets on poker and other card games, cricket, badminton, tennis and football matches and even election outcomes.

ED has claimed, in one of its charge sheets in the case, that the 'betting empire' was operating at least 3,200 betting parlours in different cities, generating around ₹240 crore per day.

Former Chhattisgarh chief minister Bhupesh Baghel is also named as accused in the probe. He has consistently denied his involvement.

In March, ED attached 20 immovable properties worth ₹1.70 crore including high-value luxury villas in an estate and apartments in Burj Khalifa in Dubai linked to Chandrakar.

The financial crimes probe agency has claimed that 'Mahadev Online Book operated as a large-scale international betting syndicate, which facilitated illegal betting through multiple online platforms and domain names such as Tiger Exchange, Gold365 and Laser247.'

TVK GOVT MARKS TWO SITES FOR A SECOND AIRPORT, DMK SLAMS MOVE

S Vijay Karthik
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu government has identified two sites near Chennai for the ambitious second airport near Chennai and a team of officials have completed the preliminary study, people aware of the matter said on Sunday.

The two sites identified are Cheyur and Thengalapuram district (about 100 km south of Chennai) and the one at Manallore near Gummidipundi in Tiruvallur district (about 50 km North of Chennai).

Citing environmental concerns, the ruling Tamilanna Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government in August scrapped the proposal to set up an airport at Parandur — a flagship project announced by the former chief minister MK Stalin during the previous DMK regime.

The DMK criticised the TVK government over first cancelling the project and then conducting a fresh survey at Parandur. DMK spokesperson TKS Elangovan said, "Everything was ready in Parandur (for establishing an airport). But, they (TVK government) wanted to cancel it. They are now setting up a new airport in Cheyur and Gummidipundi. I do not understand why this is happening."

One of world's largest vessels at Paradip



MV Mineral Kwangang, a Capesize vessel — one of the largest ships in the world — with a 16.5-metre draft berthed at Western Dock-1 of Paradip Port in Odisha's Jagatsinghpur on Sunday. The ship was carrying 152,702MT of coal from Australia.

MEA: World map must depict J&K, Ladakh as per India's official map

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India on Sunday qualified its support for a UN General Assembly resolution on a map that shows the true size of countries by saying that the country's sovereign territory, including Jammu and Kashmir, must be depicted in line with New Delhi's official map.

The resolution on 'Correct the map: Rebalancing global cartographic representation and promoting equitable representation of the world's regions, particularly Africa', was adopted on Friday by a vote of 164 in favour to one against (United States), and six abstentions.

The UN described it as an important step towards correcting distortions in commonly used world maps, especially the Mercator projection, which are seen as 'misrepresenting the relative size of continents and contribute to a

INDIA SAID ITS SOVEREIGN TERRITORY MUST BE DEPICTED IN ACCORDANCE WITH INDIA'S OFFICIAL MAP

diminished perception of Africa".

However, the resolution favours the Equal Earth projection — created in 2018 by the cartographers Bojan Savrie, Bernhard Jenny and Tom Patterson — which inaccurately depicts the northern frontiers of India by showing parts of Jammu and Kashmir within the borders of China and Pakistan.

"India voted in favour of the resolution and also made an explanation of vote stressing on the underlying principle of promoting equal representation of all countries, external affairs minister spokesperson Randhir Jaishwal said.

"We also highlighted that the resolution does not constitute endorsement of any specific map, projection or definition of national boundaries."

Jaishwal made it clear that India's sovereignty over Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, "must be depicted in accordance with India's official map". He added, "Any inaccurate or misleading depiction is unacceptable. Our position on India's sovereignty and territorial integrity is clear, consistent and non-negotiable."

Jaishwal noted that the UN resolution's purpose is encouraging the use of equal-area map projections that preserve the relative sizes of continental landmasses. "The resolution neither adopts nor authenticates any particular world map, nor does it address political cartography, including territorial boundaries, disputed territories or place names," he said.

{ GREENPIECE }

SHIFT FROM DIGITAL CAMPAIGNS ALONE TO ON-GROUND CHANGE IS CRUCIAL

Bharati Chaturvedi
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Bittu Tabahi, or Surendra Singh Choudhry, 20, is a special citizen. Not because he has cleaned the Arun river in Madhya Pradesh—largely by himself—and pushed for heavy equipment to remove thick sludge. Not because he creates catchy social media posts; far more high-profile people have done this and received global awards. He stands out because he uses social media not to shine the spotlight on himself, but on society at large.

He speaks candidly about how hard he has worked, and how, just when the river began to look healthier, someone else stepped in and changed the 'moment' or innovation. He has chutzpah. His work should nudge elite urban environmentalists to ask whether giving up plastics and making eco-bricks is enough.

It should nudge citizens to ask what their role is in keeping the country healthy—apart from monitoring what the government does.

On July 15 this year, he held up a stained, soiled Tricolour retrieved from the river. It was a mirror showing us what we had done to the country.

"I am all for his 1 million social media followers to double, because in the midst of this climate emergency—as climate anxiety mounts among young people—there is no shame in standing in the mud and solving the problem hands-on."

I am also all for shifting from digital campaigns alone to using one's limited resources to create on-ground change without expecting a recommendation letter in return.

HAL ALL SET TO DELIVER 3 HIT-40 TRAINERS TO IAF

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) is set to deliver the first batch of delayed HIT-40 basic trainer aircraft to the Indian Air Force, bolstering the air force's capacity to meet its growing pilot training requirements, officials aware of the development said on Sunday.

Three HIT-40 (Hindustan Turbo Trainer-40) aircraft, two built at Bengaluru and one at Nashik, are ready for delivery, the officials said, asking not to be named.

The IAF ordered 70 basic trainers after 6,763,838 crore three years ago to train its rookie pilots. Under the contract, HAL was to deliver 12 trainers to the IAF in fiscal 2025-26 but failed to deliver any aircraft due to a shortage of engines. US firm Honeywell overcame supply chain bottlenecks and delivered the first batch of TPEC31-128 turboprop engines a few months ago and assured the state-run firm of timely supplies.

Under a \$100 million contract signed four years ago for supplying and manufacturing 88 TPEC31-128 engines/kits, Honeywell was supposed to deliver them by September 2025. The US firm will supply 16 units and HAL will build the rest through technology transfer.

Last October, defence minister Rajnath Singh inaugurated production lines for the HIT-40 basic trainer and LCA-MkIIA in Nashik to meet the air force's needs. HAL is now producing a total of 29 HIT-40s a year at its factories in Bengaluru and Nashik.

Currently, an elite (Stage-I) Pilot Training School for all rookie pilots is carried out on Swiss-origin Pilatus PC-7 MkII basic trainers. Stage-I training is common for all pilots after which tri-orientation into fighter, transport and helicopter streams takes place. Those selected for the fighter stream proceed to Stage-II training on PC-7 MkII and Hawk MkIIA jet trainers and then Stage-III on the British-origin Hawk advanced jet trainers.



4 of a family killed in Kanpur house cave-in

HT Correspondent
letters@htlive.com

LUCKNOW: Four members of a family—including three girls aged 16, 12 and seven—were killed when their mud house collapsed amid rain in a village in Uttar Pradesh's Kanpur on Sunday morning, police said. Adding their 19-year-old sister was critically injured in the incident.

Chief minister Yogi Adityanath expressed condolences to the bereaved family and directed officials to ensure proper treatment to the injured and provide all possible assistance to the family, officials said.

The deceased were identified as 45-year-old daily-wage labourer Mukesh and his daughters Maya, Neetu, and Pallavi. His 19-year-old daughter Kajal is undergoing treatment in Halet Hospital in Kanpur, police added. The incident took place around 9.30am in Hirni village when the family was inside the house. Villagers said the structure had weakened due to incessant rainfall over the past few days and suddenly collapsed, trapping the family under the debris.

Heard about the house collapse, villagers rushed to the spot and began rescue, while police and administration officials were also informed. After nearly two hours, the five family members were pulled from the

TVK functionary hacked to death in Chennai; 5 arrested

CHENNAI: A 45-year-old TVK functionary was murdered allegedly by a group of five people in Chennai's Adyar, police said on Sunday, adding that all the accused have been arrested. The incident triggered a political row, with Opposition parties targeting the TVK.

The deceased, a Kannan, ran a car rental business catering to IT firms and was a history-seeker with a criminal record, police said.

Reacting to the incident, Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin alleged the TVK was a "dumping ground where criminals seek refuge".

Pharma trader murdered in his Kanpur flat

LUCKNOW: A 63-year-old wholesale medicine trader was brutally murdered inside his flat at a residential apartment complex in Kanpur's Kalyanpur area, police said on Sunday.

The victim was attacked with a sharp-edged weapon. Police said the body of Vineet Minocha, a resident of Ratan Orbit Apartment in Indira Nagar, was found lying in a pool of blood early Sunday morning. They said his throat had been slit and there were multiple injuries on his body. ACP Kalyanpur Dilip Singh said a case had been registered and two persons had been detained for questioning.

Young couple found dead in Kerala lake, police suspect suicide

KOLLAM: A young couple who had chosen to live together despite opposition from their families were found dead in Sasthamcotta Lake in this district, in an apparent suicide, police said here on Sunday.

The deceased—19 and 26—are believed to have reached the lake on Saturday evening and jumped into the water, police said. Their bodies were recovered on Sunday. Police said the two had been in a relationship for some time and had been living together in recent months. Their relationship had earlier led to intervention by the police.

Have fun with facts on Sundays

Catch the latest column of



A quiz on the week's development.



HAVE FUN WITH FACTS ON SUNDAYS

Catch the latest column of



A quiz on the week's development.



(The writer is the founder and director of Chintan Environment Research and Action Groups)

SMARTER FINANCIAL
DECISIONS START HERE
EVERY WEDNESDAY

INTRODUCING

Hindustan Times
YOUR MONEY
PERSONAL FINANCE. MADE SIMPLE.

Better financial decisions begin with better understanding. This weekly series helps you navigate money with greater confidence.



SPEND



SAVE



INVEST



PLAN

READ EVERY WEDNESDAY



BUILDING COLLAPSE

As of midnight, officials said several people were still likely trapped, with personnel from the police, Delhi Fire Services (DFS) and Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA) combing through the rubble. A clutch of students caught in the mounds of concrete, brick and rebar, made desperate calls for help to their friends and relatives, while others circulated videos from within the debris to draw the attention of rescue workers.

HT received an 11-second video from students recorded by a person caught in the debris. It showed a man bleeding and trapped between large blocks of concrete. By evening, it emerged this man, who was identified as Aditya Kumar, a DU student, was alive and stable, his brother Ankit Kumar said.

Condolences poured in from across political circles. Prime Minister Narendra Modi called the collapse distressing and said the government would do everything possible to bring back the lives of those who were trapped.

Most residents studied at three Delhi University colleges in the vicinity — Sri Venkateswara College, Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College and Motilal Nehru College — and came from Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Jammu and Kerala, said local residents.

Nitin Jamwal (19), a student of Motilal Nehru College who lived at the hostel until about a year ago, said: "Everything here was bad. The walls were cracking, the basement used to fill up with water."

His friend Nitesh Chib was among those initially trapped in the collapse. He was later rescued, said Jamwal, who now lives in another PG accommodation in the vicinity.

The building, opposite Sri Venkateswara College, on the west of Benito Juarez Marg, is one of dozens of PG accommodations in the congested resettlement colony built without any planning or layout norms. The area is packed with restaurants, cafes, roadside eateries, stationary shops and grocery stores.

Even though police said repairs were being carried out on the ground floor, local residents and eyewitnesses said the work was on in the basement. Gupta, during her visit to Satya Niketan, said, "The building was old, and some construction work was underway. Some kind of excavation was being carried out in the basement, due to which a pillar shifted and the entire building collapsed."

The collapse is the latest in a run of building failures and fires in Delhi over the past year that have raised questions about reg-

ulation, enforcement and safety rules in the city.

On March 18, a fire at a bed-and-breakfast in Hauz Rani killed at least 23 people, including foreign nationals. Four days earlier, the collapse of an illegal building in adjacent Saidulajab killed six. In May, a fire tore through a residential building in Vivek Vihar, killing nine. On March 18, a fire at a bed-and-breakfast in Hauz Rani killed at least 23 people, including foreign nationals. Four days earlier, the collapse of an illegal building in adjacent Saidulajab killed six. In May, a fire tore through a residential building in Vivek Vihar, killing nine.

The building had about 15 rooms, with two to three students in each, said Rajen Chhetri, a local resident who works with Delhi Police. Rooms were let on a twin- and triple-sharing basis at about ₹12,000 to ₹15,000 a bed per month.

Adarsh Pandey (19), a student from Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College, said one of his friends was in the building and his parents were calling him. "I have been trying to call him since it has happened but he is not taking calls... What do I tell his parents," said Pandey.

Neighbours said Bansal and his two brothers owned a stationery store and residence until two-three years ago. They later moved and rented the building out.

Meanwhile, colleges in the neighbourhood opened up their hostels for survivors and students who wanted to leave their PG accommodations in Satya Niketan.

ARSD college principal Gyan-tosh Jha said, "We have opened the college canteen for students to have food. We have made arrangements for students to stay at the nearby community centre and gurdwara. We will assess the situation on Monday."

The 55-square-yard property at P-14, Satya Niketan, comprised a basement and ground to fourth floors, though officials said alterations being carried out in the ground floor were unauthorised and that no building plans had been sanctioned for the structure.

The building also lacked a no-objection certificate from the fire department, mandatory for buildings taller than nine metres that accommodate more than 20 students.

A drive to check illegal construction, announced after the Hauz Rani and Saidulajab incidents, did not continue.

Following the Hauz Rani fire, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and district authorities launched inspections of commercial establishments and buildings suspected of violating fire-safety and building norms. The Delhi government had ordered a citywide

enforcement drive, with joint teams comprising district officials, police, civic authorities and fire personnel tasked with checking hotels, guest houses, nursing homes, coaching centres, restaurants and other vulnerable establishments.

But the enforcement push fizzled out after the initial month.

There were directions issued to check buildings but later officials were asked to only ensure no new construction is taking place. There were also instructions given on identifying G+4 structures. Different directions were issued at different times and following the initial push, inspections were stopped after it was felt that the vulnerable areas have been covered," said an official who asked not to be named.

Responding to queries on the Sunday collapse, MCD said in a statement that the building is part of a resettlement colony with an area of around 55 square yards and has reportedly built in the 1990s.

Later, MCD in the presence of all illegal constructions with more than four floors will be immediately sealed, and strict action will be taken against the guilty officials, leading to their immediate dismissal.

"These orders will be implemented with immediate effect," said the statement.

Sunday's collapse also comes four-and-a-half years after an under-construction building fell in the same neighbourhood, a few metres away, killing two and injuring four.

President Droupadi Murmu said she was saddened by the loss of lives in the collapse.

Prime Minister Modi condoned the loss of lives.

"The collapse of a building at Satya Niketan, Delhi is distressing. Condolences to those who lost their loved ones. Praying for the speedy recovery of the injured. Authorities are working at the site and assisting those affected in the mishap," he said on X.

Union home minister Amit Shah said he spoke to the chief minister and senior officials in the Capital, as he assured medical aid for the injured.

"Spoke with the Chief Minister, Commissioner of Police, Delhi, and the Director General, NDRF, and assessed the situation on the ground," he said.

Chief minister Gupta vowed strict action against those responsible.

Gupta said the government's priority was to save those trapped under the debris and assess the condition of those who had been rescued.

"I can say this much: whoever is responsible for this,

whether it is the building owner or an official, will not be spared," she said.

The collapse also prompted protests by students' organisations.

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) — the student wing of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh — staged a protest outside Civic Centre, the MCD headquarters, on Sunday evening, demanding the corporation's commissioner step down, as well as an immediate safety audit of all PG accommodations.

VOLCANIC ERUPTION

On Sunday, the local port authority said in a social media post.

Operations have also been suspended at seven other airports including the Husein Sastranegara airport in Bandung and Radin Inten II airport near Bandar Lampung on Sumatra, the transportation ministry said in a statement. "From the closures, it is known that more than 150,000 passengers were stranded, with 467 flights affected, consisting of 58 international flights and 409 domestic flights," the ministry said. Several airports in cities including Semarang and Surabaya have been prepared as "alternatives for landing," Transportation Minister Dudy Purwangandi said.

Passengers scrambling The disruption left some passengers scrambling to find alternative flights. Henry Yensan, 44, who had hoped to go back to his hometown with her mother, said "everybody was disappointed".

"No one here is in a rage because after all, this is due to natural disaster," the businesswoman who had to reschedule her flight to Tuesday, told AFP.

Samuel Guilbert, a Danone executive on a business trip to Lombok since Friday, said "nothing is certain for the moment", as he searched for alternative flights back to the capital.

"I had found another flight on Citilink, but it was also cancelled," the 47-year-old told AFP by phone, adding that he had no alternative but to stay in Lombok for the time being.

Volcanic ash had also reached the city of Bandar Lampung in the southern tip of Sumatra, blanketing parked cars and roadsides.

"I'm worried it could seriously affect the lungs and cause a lung infection," Andre Bayu Saputra, 25, told AFP on Sunday. Schools across Jakarta will be closed on Monday as classes will move online, the city said in a statement, without specifying how long the measure will be in place.

Hazard warning Anak Krakatau, which means

Child of Krakatoa, sits in a strait that separates the islands of Java and Sumatra.

Ships passing through the strait were asked to increase vigilance for possible disruption to navigation safety due to volcanic activities.

Vessels are prohibited from approaching an exclusion zone of three kilometres radius from the volcano, local port authorities said in a statement.

The volcano has been sporadically active since it emerged from the sea at the beginning of last century in the caldera that formed after the 1883 eruption of Mount Krakatoa.

That disaster was one of the deadliest and most destructive in history with an estimated 35,000 people killed.

Geology agency head Lana Saria said "seismic activity caused the movement or release of volcanic fluids within the volcanic system".

"However, the timing, magnitude, and nature of the next eruption cannot be precisely predicted," Lana added.

Lana warned against approaching Anak Krakatau, saying materials ejected from the volcano could endanger those within the exclusion zone.

She said the most recent series of eruptions do not have the potential to trigger a tsunami at this time. A 2018 tsunami triggered by a collapse of parts of Anak Krakatau killed 429 people and left thousands displaced.

Indonesia, a Southeast Asian archipelago nation, sits on the Pacific Ring of Fire, where the meeting of continental plates causes high volcanic and seismic activity.

W ASIA CONFLICT

Iran's interests and security will receive a faster, more intense and more painful response," he added, in a speech carried by state media.

On Saturday, US Central Command (CENTCOM), which oversees American military operations in the region, said Iran had unsuccessfully fired at two American warships — an aircraft carrier and a destroyer.

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, the ideological arm of Iran's military, said the warships had been "forced to retreat" after "suffering damage", but CENTCOM said they successfully evaded the attacks.

In response, the US military said it struck three oil tankers linked to the Iranian Guards.

CENTCOM said it had "permanently disabled" one ship off the coast of the oil hub of Kharg Island and another near Jask, and "completely destroyed" a third vessel in the Gulf of Oman.

Video posted by the military showed large fireballs and billowing flames after projectiles

slammed into the ships.

"The three vessels were 'part of a multibillion-dollar shadow network that funds the IRGC and its regional proxies'," CENTCOM said.

Iran quickly retaliated, with the Guards saying their naval forces "targeted three oil tankers on the unauthorised route of the Strait of Hormuz and three vessels affiliated with the child-killing America in other areas".

It warned ships not to attempt to transit the key trade waterway via routes unapproved by Tehran.

Early on Sunday Iran's Guards also said they attacked a US naval drone trying to enter the strait, according to a statement carried by state television.

CENTCOM spokesman Captain Tim Hawkins, however, called the claim "a complete lie".

"No US vessels have been attacked today," he said.

"Clinging on to power" — CENTCOM commander Admiral Brad Cooper had said after the exchange of strikes: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."

The Iranian foreign ministry condemned the attacks on its oil tankers as "illegal and aggressive actions".

The administration of US President Donald Trump has tried to downplay the significance of the six-month conflict, which has proven increasingly unpopular at home as midterm elections near.

US Vice President JD Vance has gone so far as to say that he "wouldn't call it a war".

Trump reiterated that view on Friday, calling the war "small potatoes" for Washington.

Iranian officials have so far maintained their defiant tone, but US Energy Secretary Chris Wright told ABC's "This Week" programme on Sunday that Iran was "doing everything they can to cling on to something".

"They know their nuclear programme's coming to an end. Their navy has come to an end. Their air force has come to an end. They're clinging on to power," he said.

A fragile ceasefire between the two sides collapsed in July after attacks on commercial ships in the Hormuz strait, through which one-fifth of world oil supplies previously flowed.

Trump has in recent weeks repeatedly threatened to claim sovereignty over the strait, even posting a map showing it as "new US territory".

Vance has insisted the US will not reopen talks with Iran until it ends attacks on commercial shipping in the strait.

ISRO to remain bedrock of Indian space sector: INSPACE chairperson

Snehal Fernandes
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Two days after nine associations representing thousands of Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) employees sought clarity on the privatisation of the space sector, IN-SPACE chairman Pawan Goenka and ISRO on Sunday said the space agency's role would not diminish.

Goenka said there had been "some misleading narrative" in the media about ISRO's future role. "Let me say it unequivocally: ISRO's role is by no means diminishing. It will remain the bedrock of Indian space sector. The reforms since 2020 are about expanding India's overall space ecosystem," he said in a post on X.

The employees' associations had written to the Department of Space Secretary and ISRO chairman V Narayanan seeking clarity after Goenka said that "eventually, ISRO will not make any launch vehicles and will not manufacture any launch vehicles. That will all be done by the private sector or PSU".

The associations sought clarity on whether Goenka's statement represented government policy, besides asking about the transfer of ISRO's manufacturing and operational functions, the agency's future role and the impact on serving employees

and future generations.

ISRO, in a separate post on X on Sunday, said neither it would be privatised nor its importance diminished.

The agency said private-sector participation would enable the agency to focus on the next generation of India's space programme while industry scales mature technologies.

ISRO said its "role will progressively strengthen in areas where its scientific expertise matters most: frontier R&D, advanced technologies, human spaceflight, next-generation launch systems, deep-space and planetary missions and strategic national capabilities."

"Meanwhile, mature and routinely manufactured systems can increasingly be scaled through industry. Production of mature launch vehicles, routine satellites and other established systems can increasingly be undertaken by industry or PSUs through appropriate competitive processes," said ISRO.

{ AT BENGALURU } 270 PASSENGERS ON BOARD

London flight makes emergency landing

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: A London-bound Virgin Atlantic flight carrying 270 passengers was forced to make an "emergency landing" at the Kempegowda International Airport in Bengaluru on Sunday after developing a technical glitch, people aware of the matter said.

The flight took off from KJAB at around 8.20am but developed a technical issue soon after departure, prompting the crew to circle the aircraft near Tumakuru for more than half an hour before returning to Bengaluru.

All passengers on board are safe, people aware of the matter said, adding that the aircraft was brought back to KJAB as a safety

precaution and made an emergency landing. The exact nature of the technical problem was not immediately known.

A spokesperson of Virgin Atlantic said the VS317 flight from Bengaluru to London Heathrow returned to Bengaluru after departure due to a technical issue. "The aircraft landed safely as a precaution and the flight was subsequently cancelled," he said in a statement adding that the safety and security of its customers and crew is always its top priority.

"We sincerely apologise for the inconvenience caused to our customers. Our teams are supporting those affected and are working hard to rebook them onto alternative services," the company said.

HAZARDOUS

WITH FACTS ON SUNDAYS

Catch the latest column of



THE WEEK THAT WAS

A quiz on the week's development.



hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

WORLD

Iran's strait leverage wanes amid US economic squeeze

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

ISTANBUL: Six months after a conflict that rattled markets and pushed the Gulf to the brink of a wider war, the tide may be turning against Iran as Washington unleashes an unprecedented economic offensive to achieve what military force could not.

After years of surviving sanctions, Tehran is now confronting one of the harshest squeezes in the Islamic Republic's history, according to Iranian insiders and regional sources. A US naval blockade and tougher sanctions are curbing oil exports, restricting access to foreign currency and exposing growing strains in the economy. The campaign has led US and regional officials to wager that mounting pressure can force Iran to allow free passage through the strait that carries a fifth of global oil and LNG.

Their bet rests on a simple calculation: Iran is suffering more economic damage than it is inflicting. Efforts to choke off oil exports have cut state revenues, while attempts to disrupt shipping through Hormuz have not triggered the global economic shock Tehran hoped would force Washington to compromise. Energy markets have adjusted and alternative supplies have continued to flow.

"The balance of power has tilted against Iran a bit," said Iranian analyst Arash Azizi. Iran is losing some of the leverage it had over the Strait of Hormuz because it has been unable to close it fully, he said, adding that the US naval blockade was "really hitting Iran."

Azizi said Tehran had expected disruption in the strait to trigger a major shock to the global economy and drive Washington back to the negotiating table.

"It hasn't happened, really," he said. Other countries had adapted, exposing limits to Iran's ability to inflict economic pain on the region and beyond.



A cargo vessel carrying shipping containers is anchored in the Strait of Hormuz on Sunday.

Whether the pressure will force concessions remains unclear, the regional sources said. Tehran has failed to impose the costs it hoped would break Washington's resolve but has shown little sign of abandoning demands for sanctions relief, access to frozen assets and recognition of its security role in Hormuz.

Still, a new formula for resolving the standoff is now under discussion between mediators and Iran, the sources said.

Three senior Iranian sources acknowledged that Washington's campaign is becoming increasingly difficult to withstand.

The latest measures have sharply restricted Tehran's ability to access foreign currency, import goods and tap global financing networks that have helped keep the economy afloat.

Iranian leaders fear a worsening economy, marked by surging prices, weaker trade and pressure on household incomes, could reignite nationwide unrest that has repeatedly challenged the Islamic Republic.

OPEC+ OUTPUT POLICY WON'T CHANGE FOR OCT

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW YORK: Opec+ kept its oil output policy unchanged for October at a meeting on Sunday, it said in a statement, as the producer group needs to agree new quotas before deciding its next output steps.

The meeting of seven core Opec+ members — Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Algeria, Kazakhstan and Oman — comes as the Iran war continues to disrupt oil exports through the Strait of Hormuz, limiting Opec+ influence over prices and market share.

In August, Opec+ agreed its production boost for September, completing a phased roll-back of a 1.65 million-barrel-per-day supply cut first agreed in 2023. Despite the agreed production increases, the group still produces far below its targets because of the war.

LEBANON SEEKS U.S. HELP AS ISRAEL KILLS 7 IN STRIKES

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

ARABSALEM: Lebanese President Joseph Aoun urged Washington and the international community to help stop Israeli attacks, which killed at least seven people on Sunday despite a truce and a framework deal aimed at halting the violence.

Israel said it had targeted Hezbollah operatives and sites in response to a drone attack a day earlier by the Iran-backed group on its troops in the vicinity of a strategic south Lebanon ridge.

It reported no casualties but accused Hezbollah of a "blatant violation". Israel this week said it had captured the Ali al-Taher ridge, which it considers part of its self-declared "security zone" in south Lebanon. Hezbollah, which has not claimed any attacks for weeks, has not commented on Israel's declaration of control over the site.

US envoys, European allies meet in Kyiv after 'useful' Putin talks

Agencies
letters@hindustantimes.com

KYIV: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky met with President Donald Trump's envoys in Kyiv, a day after Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner held talks with Moscow with President Vladimir Putin in pursuit of a way to end Russia's war in Ukraine, Bloomberg reported.

The trio, along with Ukraine's negotiating team, also met with top national security officials from the UK, Germany and France, who travelled to Kyiv for Sunday's talks. Their attendance hadn't been previously announced. Kushner and Witkoff, who've

made several trips to Moscow, are in Ukraine for the first time. Their visit has been shadowed by scepticism that Washington's renewed peace outreach can end Russia's four-and-half year old full-scale invasion of Ukraine.

"We all want to end the war, and we are on the same page here," Zelensky said. "Every such meeting gets us closer to peace."

Putin's meeting with Witkoff and Kushner was "substantive, constructive, extremely frank and trusting," Kremlin foreign policy aide Yuri Ushakov said in comments distributed by Russian media. "Our president reaffirmed his readiness to continue working jointly with

the Americans to seek political and diplomatic solutions."

Ushakov described Saturday's meeting as "highly useful", while a White House official told Reuters that next steps would be announced in the coming weeks.

Trump's diplomatic envoys were earlier greeted by Zelensky at the historic St. Sophia's Cathedral in central Kyiv after arriving in the capital by train. Rustem Umerov, head of Ukraine's foreign intelligence service, posted a video of the pair disembarking after their rail journey.

The visit follows the US officials' more than three hours of talks in Moscow on Saturday that a Kremlin aide called

"highly useful." Putin opened the meeting by describing the situation in Ukraine as "not a simple one." People familiar with the thinking in Kyiv said Ukraine is pessimistic about meaningful progress resulting from the Witkoff-Kushner visit.

Zelensky earlier gathered his negotiating team, including Davyd Arakhamia, Serhiy Kyslytsia, Rustem Umerov, Kyrylo Budanov, ahead of the US envoys' arrival.

"We are ready for the conversation. Ukraine has always been and will remain constructive," Zelenskyy said on X. "Security guarantees are needed. A dignified character of the postwar peace is needed. Our proposals are ready."



FBI to extradite Indian-origin fraudster: Kash

WASHINGTON: Manjeet Singh Bedi, a most-wanted fraudster accused of defrauding the US government of \$600,000, has been arrested in India, FBI director Kash Patel said. FBI said Bedi ran a small grocery store in Washington, and swiped customers' government benefits cards to give them cash instead of food. FBI is actively working to secure his return to the US. Patel said in a post on X.



Ald candidate Ulrich Siegmund, wife Julia.

said a jubilant Ulrich Siegmund, the 35-year-old lead candidate of the anti-immigration Alternative for Germany party in Saxony-Anhalt state, as the vote count continued.

German far-right AfD likely to win eastern state vote: Exit polls

MAGDEBURG: Germany's far-right AfD won a landslide victory in a key regional election Sunday in the ex-communist east, according to exit polls, but it remains unclear whether it can win an absolute majority to govern. "We have made history today,"

25 die in bus crash on Cape Verde's Fogo island

LSBON: At least 25 people, many of them schoolchildren and teenagers, were killed when a bus plunged into a ravine on Fogo, one of Cape Verde's islands in the Atlantic Ocean off the coast of West Africa, Inforpress reported on Sunday.

Trump slams Canada over dollar 'imbalance', Spain on migrant crisis

Agencies
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump slammed Canada for its "currency imbalance" with the US in a post on his social media platform Truth Social on Sunday.

"Canada's (currency) Dollar imbalance with the US is unacceptable," Trump said. He also criticised Spain regarding the migrant crisis affecting the Spanish territory of Ceuta, accusing Madrid of maintaining zero control over its borders.

Through another post published on Truth Social, Trump said, "So sad what is happening in Spain, a country with ZERO control of its border. WOW!"

Trump's remarks emerged as Spain continued addressing the aftermath of a massive migrant surge from Morocco into Ceuta, alongside ongoing questions concerning the conduct of

Moroccan security forces during the incident, ANI reported. This followed prior criticism directed at Spain by Trump during an interview with British television channel GB News.

Addressing the situation during his conversation with GB News, Trump censured Spain's handling of the crisis, which saw thousands of Moroccan migrants swimming towards the Spanish enclave in North Africa last July, triggering numerous arrests and over 140 fatalities.

Although a majority of individuals have since returned voluntarily, thousands remain stationed within Ceuta, sustaining a prominent political debate across Europe.

"Invasion of a country", Trump issued a warning that Spain faces destruction, telling GB News during the sit-down interview, "Spain will be a ruined country."

Don't Just Follow Culture. Understand It

Culture isn't just what's trending.

It's the ideas changing how we live. The conversations shaping what we watch, read, wear, eat, create and care about. Every Saturday, HT Brunch goes beyond what's new to explore what's next—and why it matters. Because understanding culture is always more rewarding than simply following it.



EVERY SATURDAY IN HINDUSTAN TIMES



Derivatives expiry may see return of old mechanism

Ram Sahgal and
 Apoorva Ajith
 ram.sahgal@livemint.com

MUMBAI: The stock market regulator may look to bring back the old mechanism to settle derivative contracts on expiry days, two people aware of the discussions said, in a partial revision to the closing auction session (CAS) introduced a month ago. The goal is to smooth out last-minute swings on settlement days, which often open gaps between the Nifty and Sensex.

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Thursday said it will review the settlement process after receiving market feedback and said it may issue a consultation paper on the matter within a week. According to the people cited above, while the daily CAS will continue as before, Sebi may propose settling weekly and monthly derivatives using the previous volume-weighted average price (VWAP) model, or using a combination of VWAP and CAS prices.

"Nifty and Sensex options, which expire on a weekly and



The Sebi board meeting on September 24 may discuss public feedback on the consultation paper.

monthly basis, can be settled at a 15- or 30-minute VWAP, but the tricky issue is the settlement of stock futures and options, which expire on a monthly basis. The regulator could use a combination of CAS and VWAP to settle the relevant stocks which are also index constituents," one of the two people mentioned above said on the condition of anonymity. Derivatives contracts are settled every Tuesday on the National Stock Exchange and every Thursday on the BSE.

Before CAS debuted on 3 August,

stock and index derivatives were settled using VWAP—average price an asset has traded at, weighted by how much volume traded at each price—during the last 30 minutes of trading.

However, since CAS was introduced for 23 stocks eligible for derivatives trading, settlement occurred at prices discovered in thinly traded auctions held at 3:35-3:50 pm. Essentially, options contracts with premium value in tens of thousands of rupees were settled based on prices reached in a thinly

traded auction of ₹1,200-1,300 crore between NSE and BSE.

A Sebi official was not immediately available for comment. "By distorting the index stock prices during the auction on settlement days, the index options positions taken prior to the auction could swing wildly, causing a divergence between the values of the Nifty and Sensex," the second person said. "Reverting to the VWAP mechanism would obviate price distortions on settlement days while the existing practice can continue on non-settlement days."

The Sebi board meeting on September 24 may discuss public feedback on the consultation paper, the first person added.

The price of a derivative is simply the expected spot price on a future date. Based on supply and demand, derivatives normally trade at a premium to spot prices. However, the derivatives price converges with the spot rate at expiry or settlement, when the spread between the two disappears.

With the introduction of CAS, the continuous trading session

(CTS) for eligible cash stocks closes at 3:35 pm, while derivatives trading in these 23 stocks continues until 3:40 pm. Under CAS, orders can be placed between 3:20 pm and 3:30 pm, with closing prices discovered based on maximum bids and offers between 3:28 pm and 3:30 pm. These prices, from which derivatives would take cues, are released at 3:35 pm and used for the settlement of derivatives at 3:40 pm.

On settlement days of Sensex or Nifty, there would be a divergence between the two indices when relatively thinly traded CAS prices are used in large-value derivatives settlements.

A key reason for the divergence between indices under CAS is the low presence of arbitrage traders and funds and retail investors. Arbitrageurs step in to buy the cheaper stock in one exchange and sell it at a higher price on the other, or exploit price differences between spot stocks and their derivatives, profiting from the gap narrowing while smoothing out price differences.

SBI TO HIRE 12K PERSONNEL, ADD 250 BRANCHES IN FY27: CHAIRMAN

Press Trust of India

feedback@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: State Bank of India (SBI) intends to hire about 12,000 personnel and add around 250 new branches to its network in the ongoing financial year, said C S Sety, chairman of the country's biggest lender.

"In terms of recruitment, I think we would be looking at around 10,000 to 12,000 appointments across both clerical and officer cadres this year. This number may vary depending on retirements and emerging requirements, but I expect we should close the year with around 12,000 recruitments," he told PTT in an interaction.

"Last year, we have done fairly large recruitment because we took 1,500 specialist IT officers. This year, we do not need such a large number on the IT (information technology) side," he said.

With a workforce of over 2.45 lakh employees as of March 2026, SBI is among India's largest employers. SBI had hired 4,640 officers, 19,340 associates, and 1,653 contractual staff in 2025-26, taking the total number of hires to 25,633, as per the bank's annual report for FY26.

Indian crude basket nears \$100 a barrel

Rajeev Jayaswal

rajeev.jayaswal@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's average crude oil import price rose to nearly \$100 a barrel, its highest level in three months, amid renewed volatility in global oil markets, while consumption of key petroleum products such as petrol and diesel also increased, according to government and industry data.

The price of the Indian crude basket was \$99.35 a barrel on Wednesday, according to the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC), and is expected to cross the \$100-mark by Friday amid renewed hostilities between the US and Iran, industry experts said. PPAC, the petroleum ministry's data keeper, publishes data on the Indian basket with a lag. The basket represents an average of the various grades of crude imported by Indian refiners, including Brent, Oman and Dubai.

Benchmark Brent crude gained nearly 1% on Friday to close at \$96.28 a barrel while West Texas Intermediate (WTI) crude settled at \$91.48, up 18 cents. Both benchmarks gained more than 9% during the week as the US-Iran conflict escalated.

Other factors contributing to the rise in global crude oil and petroleum product prices include a decline in US energy inventories and Ukraine's attacks on Russian refineries, experts said.

As a result, India's average petrol benchmark rose to a three-month high of \$102.65 a barrel in September 2026 as of Thursday, while the average diesel benchmark rose to a four-month high of \$156.44 as of September 3, according to the latest available data.

Experts said that if international oil prices continue to rise, state-run oil companies



India imports more than 88% of the crude oil it processes.

could seek the government's approval to raise pump prices of petrol and diesel, particularly as domestic consumption is also increasing.

India imports more than 88% of the crude oil it processes. However, retail petrol and diesel prices have largely been insulated from extreme international price volatility, with state-run oil marketing companies (OMCs), which control more than 90% of the country's 103,023 petrol pumps, keeping pump prices largely unchanged.

Industry executives, who did not want to be named, said public-sector OMCs are facing a double whammy. On one hand, they cannot raise petrol and diesel prices in tandem with their respective international benchmarks as the government's policy controls retail prices; on the other, demand for both fuels is rising.

According to provisional data compiled by PPAC, petrol consumption in India rose 7.9% to 3.824 thousand metric tonnes (TMT) in August 2026 from 3,544 TMT in the same month last year. Diesel consumption increased 6.4% to 7,001 TMT from 6,577 TMT during the same period.

India's invITs target over ₹20 lakh crore assets by 2030

Subhash Narayan

subhash.narayan@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's infrastructure investment trusts (invITs) will soon no longer be only about roads and telecom.

Targeting more than ₹20 lakh crore in assets by 2030, they are set for a sharp expansion with power, shipping, logistics, data centres, ports and railways coming, the next big pool of assets, according to N.S. Venkatesh, chief executive officer (CEO) of the Bharat InvITs Association, an industry lobby group.

The near-tripling of the current asset base of about ₹7.3 lakh crore will be driven by a growing pipeline of operational infrastructure assets and the need among developers and governments to recycle capital into new projects, Venkatesh said in an interview. The expansion will mark a significant evolution for a market that has so far been dominated by roads and telecom.

Roads and highways currently account for about 40% of the invIT asset base, but as the share could fall to 30-35% as newer sectors enter the market.

"Every year, you will actually see at least one sector getting

added," Venkatesh said. The shift reflects a broader change in the way infrastructure assets are financed in India.



Roads and highways currently account for about 40% of the invIT asset base.

invITs allow developers to transfer operational, cash-generating assets into a separate investment vehicle, unlock capital and deploy the proceeds into fresh projects. For investors, the model provides access to mature infrastructure assets with relatively predictable cash flows.

The distinction between operational and greenfield assets is particularly important. New infrastructure projects carry risks related to land acquisition, right of way, approvals and construction. Operational assets have an established revenue history that make them

more suitable for an investment structure designed to provide regular distributions to investors.

Power transmission and generation could become important additions to the invIT universe, while warehouses, logistics parks and data centres are emerging as potential asset classes, Venkatesh said.

The rapid growth of digital infrastructure and the need for energy-storage capacity could further widen the pipeline, he added. Shipping presents another potentially large opportunity. Ships are capable of generating identifiable revenue and

could, subject to the appropriate structure, be owned through an invIT, while a separate operator deploys them for cargo or passenger movement. Revenue from operations could then support distributions to investors.

The Bharat InvIT Association is working on standardized frameworks for such structures, Venkatesh said.

Ports could be monetized, particularly through operational terminals rather than entire port assets. Warehouses and logistics facilities could be pooled once they become operational and generate stable cash flows.

IPO ACTION INTENSIFIES AS 11 COMPANIES EYE ₹7,055CR THIS WEEK

Press Trust of India

feedback@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The primary market is poised for another action-packed week, with 11 main-board companies, including Ramenmojo, Karamara Engineering and Kanohar Electricals, set to raise ₹7,055 crore through initial public offerings (IPOs).

The IPOs are scheduled to hit the market between September 7 and September 15, with most of the issues opening for subscription on Tuesday and Wednesday.

This multi-issue rush reflects an eagerness to lock in early-stage growth equity in young companies as all these companies are below \$1 billion market cap at listing. Rajkumar Rathi, Chief Investment Officer at YES Securities, said.

The companies tapping the primary market include real estate developers, engineering and manufacturing firms, a payments and identity solutions provider, a specialty chemicals manufacturer and an online rental platform.

Of ₹7,055 crore, ₹2,722 crore (39%) is primary capital issuance, where funds go into the company, and ₹4,333 crore (61%) is a secondary sale by existing shareholders. This mobilisation highlights strong corporate confidence and robust liquidity available within the Indian primary market, Rathi said.

The funds raised through the fresh issues will largely be utilised for business expansion, capital expenditure, debt repayment, working capital requirements and other general corporate purposes.

The upcoming IPO rush follows a busy start to September, with Rays of Belief and Deepa Jewellers already launching their IPOs on September 1. In these issues, the number of companies launching IPOs in 2026 is expected to rise to 75. This includes 23 issues launched in August.

Against this backdrop, Pranav Constructions will be the first among the 11 companies to open its IPO for public subscription on September 7. The over ₹231-crore issue will close on September 9. This will be followed by Kanohar Electricals, Prasol Chemicals and Glass Wall Systems (India), which will open their IPOs on September 8.

{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

- ACROSS**
- 1 Quietly carried on as expected (8)
 - 5 Most people provide service (4)
 - 9 Prefix informed with peace (5)
 - 10 Deep hatred for a soldier we hear (7)
 - 11 I can report it myself, doctor (12)
 - 13 Chemical result of smoking marijuana? (6)
 - 14 Handwriting learnt by actors (6)
 - 15 He's put a lot of places on the map (12)
 - 20 Men held by strange gift of imagination perhaps (7)
 - 21 Sort of paint that's unsuitable (5)
 - 22 Roman reformer firm at heart (4)
 - 23 Challenged champion's delay about the final (8)

DOWN

- 1 Final thought about contemporary apartment (4)
- 2 Out of work one may take it (7)
- 3 Hard case as a challenge to a beautician (4,8)
- 4 I waiver it's different for an insect (6)
- 6 A grain found in oak (5)
- 7 A group of society women (8)
- 8 It's characteristic of revolting people (12)
- 12 Not a general medicine (9)
- 15 I'd learn about another country (7)
- 16 Squirm like a man under a summer's (6)
- 18 Correct one side (5)
- 19 Good person has a right to take the lead (4)

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17583)

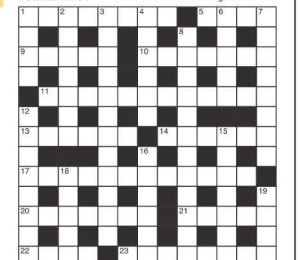


{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE HIGH + LOW

MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY
Generally cloudy sky with light rain	Generally cloudy sky with light rain	Generally cloudy sky with light rain
29°C 21°C	29°C 21°C	29°C 21°C

PUZZLE 17584 © Gemini Crosswords 2018 All rights reserved



QUICK CLUES

- ACROSS**
- 1 Became popular (6,2)
 - 2 Tenuous (4)
 - 3 Canceled (5-2-5)
 - 4 Very large amount (6)
 - 5 Known (1)
 - 6 Persons skilled in shooting (8)
 - 7 Cordially (4,4,4)
 - 8 Combative (8)
 - 9 Authentic (7)
 - 10 Unlawful premeditated killing (6)
 - 11 Bit of food as sample (5)
 - 12 Cried (4)
- DOWN**
- 1 Helpful piece of evidence (4)
 - 2 Experimental (7)
 - 3 Canceled (5-2-5)
 - 4 Very large amount (6)
 - 5 Known (1)
 - 6 Persons skilled in shooting (8)
 - 7 Cordially (4,4,4)
 - 8 Combative (8)
 - 9 Authentic (7)
 - 10 Unlawful premeditated killing (6)
 - 11 Bit of food as sample (5)
 - 12 Cried (4)

{ SUDOKU }



ALMANAC

Today in History	7th September 2026
24th of August, 1488: Vasco da Gama, Krishna Deva Raya	
18th of August, 1947: India's Independence Day	
18th of August, 1947: India's Independence Day	
18th of August, 1947: India's Independence Day	

TEMPERATURE IN METROS

City	Temp
Delhi	34°C 34°C
Mumbai	34°C 24°C
Kolkata	32°C 27°C
Chennai	38°C 25°C
Bengaluru	29°C 22°C

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

SMARTER FINANCIAL DECISIONS START HERE EVERY WEDNESDAY

INTRODUCING
Hindustan Times
YOUR MONEY
 PERSONAL FINANCE. MADE SIMPLE.

Better financial decisions begin with better understanding. This weekly series helps you navigate money with greater confidence.

READ EVERY WEDNESDAY

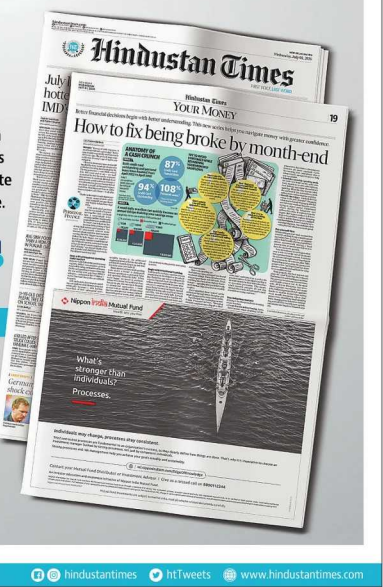
SPEND SAVE INVEST PLAN

GAME ZONE: Scan the QR code for more daily puzzles and brain teasers

hindustantimes.com

httweets

www.hindustantimes.com



Sat-Chi sets tone for Asiad with China Masters crown

The Indian pair fights back to triumph over their Chinese rivals, having twice lost in the final of the China Masters

Sandip Sikdar
sandip.sikdar@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: For Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty the Shenzhen Arena had become a familiar theatre of near misses. They had reached the summit clash of the \$1.25 million tournament twice, in 2023 and 2025, only to walk away as runners-up. But the narrative was finally rewritten on Sunday. In a solid display of resilience, tactical brilliance and nerve, the reigning Asian Games champions etched India's first-ever China Masters title, defeating China's He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang Yu 11-21, 21-13, 21-17 in an hour and 10 minutes to silence the vociferous crowd backing their own.

This was not merely a victory but a resounding statement of intent. The Super 750 event served as the ultimate crucible for the Indian pair weeks before they fly out to defend their Asian Games crown in Japan.

Earning their second title of the season from three finals, following their triumph at the Singapore Open in May, Satwik and Chirag proved once again that they are India's best bet in badminton going into any tournament.

The final, however, began as an uphill battle. The physical toll of a demanding week seemed to weigh heavily on their shoulders. It was a week during which the Indian pair spent over five hours on court battling three-game thrillers in four of their five matches.

He and Ren, feeding off the energy from the crowd, came out executing an uncompromising game as the locals disoriented the Indian defence to comfortably take the first game.

"In the first game, we weren't lacking (aggression), but we weren't playing the right strokes," said Chirag. That smart approach paid immediate dividends. Drawing on their reservoir of experience, the Indians entirely shifted the match's complexion. They quickly found their rhythm, controlled the net and dictated the rallies, taking the second game to force a dramatic decider.

The history of Satwik at this venue is intimately tied to his physical resilience. The 25-year-old has frequently battled injuries in recent years, making the pair's consistent deep runs in Shenzhen all the more remarkable.

"Playing here is always good. We have always played coming back from injury," Satwik said. "This has been a tournament that gave us a lot of confidence. Today, we held our nerves, didn't make easy mistakes and had a game plan before coming. We wanted to execute that. I'm really happy we broke the jinx."

That newfound nerve was tested to its limit in the decider as it was a back-and-forth battle of attrition. He and Ren controlled the early exchanges but the Indians tenaciously stayed within striking distance, levelling the score at 7-11. But late in the match

when the scoreboard read 16-17 in favour of the Chinese, Satwik and Chirag found an extra gear. The Indian duo rattled off five consecutive points to seal the match, coming off Satwik's serve, a feat their rivals often target and one he has spent countless hours perfecting during injury layoffs.

"It's very rare that I get five points on my service. It's always Chirag who takes the game," Satwik said with a smile. "But I was practicing more on the service when I was injured. Opponents target my service. We have seen a lot of videos, people targeting me... practice has helped me."

As the shuttle hit the floor for the final time, the relief and joy were palpable. Not only did they end their Shenzhen title wait, they also sent a message to the circuit. With the Asian Games starting on September 18, this comeback victory should act as the perfect springboard.

"It feels really special," said Chirag. "Going into the Asian Games, winning a title definitely gives a huge boost that, yes, what we are working for is in the right direction. We'll go back home, push ourselves to the limit, train for the next 10 days, and go out all guns blazing at the Asian Games. We want to go out there and have some fun."

Yamal hits double as Barca thrash Valencia

VALENCIA: Lamine Yamal struck twice as Barcelona demolished Valencia 5-0 on Sunday to maintain their 100 percent start in La Liga. The teen struck twice in the first half, with three points clear at the top after Real Madrid lost 1-0 to Real Betis on Friday. Fermin Lopez, Raphinha and Pedri were also on target for Hansi Flick's swarming visitors on a hot afternoon in Spain's east coast.

India qualify for U20 Asian Cup after 20 yrs

TASKHENT: India blanked Bangladesh 3-0 in their final group match of the AFC U20 Asian Cup Qualifiers, for their second win. The victory took India to six points from three matches. With Syria losing 0-3 to Uzbekistan, India finished second in Group B and qualified for the AFC U20 Asian Cup main tournament after 20 years as one of the seven best runners-up teams.

Mansi loses in final of Indonesia Masters

JAKARTA: Young Indian shuttler Mansi Shrivastava produced an impressive show to finish runner-up at the Indonesia Masters Super 100 badminton tournament after going down to China's Xu Wenjing in the women's singles final. The 21-year-old from Uttar Pradesh, who was world No. 76, suffered a 16-21, 8-21 loss to the world No. 81 Chinese star Terepud Ahmad Yani in South Pontianak.



Sat-Chi's shining 2026

	CHINA MASTERS	WORLD C'SHIPS	JAPAN OPEN	INDONESIA OPEN	SINGAPORE OPEN	THAILAND OPEN	SWISS OPEN	ALL ENGLAND	INDIA OPEN	MALAYSIA OPEN
CHAMPIONS	★									
5F										
QF										
R16										
R32										

India's Satwiksairaj Rankireddy (R) and Chirag Shetty (L) on way to winning the China Masters men's doubles final. **49P**

Arsenal pass Chelsea test with 2-1 victory

Agencies

sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

LONDON: Arsenal passed their biggest test so far in the defence of their Premier League title in style as they hit back from conceding inside two minutes to beat Chelsea 2-1 on Sunday.

Morgan Rogers volleyed the visitors ahead after 77 seconds but Arsenal's response was emphatic with Kai Havertz equalling after 25 minutes and Benjamin Odgaard finishing off a flowing move shortly after the break for the decisive goal.

Chelsea were never out of contention in an absorbing high-octane duel and substitute Estevao was denied a late equaliser by a superb save from David Raya. Victory left Arsenal level at the top with Manchester City with both sides at a maximum nine points after three games. Chelsea's first dropped points left them on six.

Frustated Manchester United manager Michael Carrick said his team is hurting after conceding with virtually the last kick of the game in a 2-2 draw at Everton. United twice led after goals from Bryan Mbeumo and Benjamin Sesko, but conceded in the 96th minute as Ainsley Maitland-Niles scored with a scorching drive from 35 yards.

Everton's first goal from Tyrone George was also a fine strike and Carrick was left to rue his side's misfortune at the Hill Dickinson Stadium.

"They're two fantastic strikers from in and outside the box, so they don't go in too often. I thought we did a lot of good things in the game to get us in the position we were in twice," he told the BBC.

"Some of our attacking play was really good and we looked dangerous and did a lot of things that we were trying to do. And for the most part, I thought we dealt with them quite well."

"It hurts as we came here to win and we put ourselves in a good position."

Susan Ninan

susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: At 15, Yagiz Kaan Erdogmus is already discovering that being the most talked about teen in chess right now comes with its own peculiar burden. In his case, first there are the rating goals. His coach, Azerbaijani grandmaster Shakhriyar Mamedyarov, has declared the never-before-seen 2900 as his Everest. The teen almost casually states a desire to become world champion "as young as possible" — a preference younger than Gukesh, who at 18 became the youngest undisputed world champion.

"Gukesh winning the world title had a huge impact on me," the precocious teen from Bursa, Turkey told HT. "I was surprised. It was an incredible thing. He played well and deserved to win against Ding (Liren). I also want to become world champion. I want to surpass Gukesh and become the youngest."

It is an ambitious clock to race against. Erdogmus knows it. The numbers do not seem to frighten him yet. Nor does the fact that Magnus Carlsen, the player he grew up idolising, has already told the world that he may be the best 14-year-old around. At 14, he became the youngest player to cross 2700 and says 2800 is a "barrier that even Carlsen hasn't breached."

He needs to get to 2750 first. There is something refresh-



Turkish teenager Yagiz Kaan Erdogmus.

MICHAEL WALLIS/AP

ingly adolescent about this confidence. He likes bullet chess, table tennis and tennis. He is happy to do so online. Though Mamedyarov, who touched a peak rating of 2820, has drawn the line at his protégé playing bullet.

On Sunday, at the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, student went up against the master and came away with a loss and a lesson. Playing for the PBC Alaskan Knights led by Vishwanathan Anand, Erdogmus

found himself staring at a checkmate threat set up by Mamedyarov, who turned out for CheQ Mumbai Masters, and resigned.

"When we solve positions together, he just sees everything immediately. He calculates really fast and really well," he said. "I'm more of a tactical player. I like going for sacrifices and I realise I'm quite positional. I'm also creative with my openings. My calculation is also very good. I prefer to discuss positions with my coach without looking at engines. I look at them later to not just know the answers but to try to understand why the moves work."

Classical chess may matter more to him, but for fun he turns to bullet chess. "I find bullet to be the most enjoyable format. Of course, classical is important. It's also more stressful because you need to achieve something that's like a really big goal. Gukesh became classical world champion that's why he's so popular."

Kishan's unbeaten ton puts East on top vs South

HT Correspondent

sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

KOLKATA: Ishan Kishan reaffirmed his commitment to red-ball cricket with a glittering hundred as East Zone took control of the Duleep Trophy final with a commanding start against South Zone at Chennai on Sunday.

East Zone finished the first day at 385/4 with Kishan making an unbeaten 111. The left-hander's 10th first-class century came from 135 balls, contained 14 fours and a six, and took him past 4,000 first-class runs. More importantly, it came in a final in which East's batting depth threatened to make the South attack look increasingly ordinary.

There was a time when Kishan's commitment to the longer format was questioned. He had walked away from domestic cricket, a decision that ultimately cost him his central contract. On Sunday, with his team needing substance rather than reputation, he supplied plenty of it.

He did not rush towards his hundred. The innings was built in stages. There were long periods of conventional defence against Shreyas Gopal's leg spin and spells in which Mohammed Siraj and Chama Millard tested him with short bowling. Kishan absorbed it, rode the bounce and waited. Then, as his fifty approached, the change was unmistakable.

Gopal tossed one up and Kishan came down the track, lifting it over deep midwicket for six. Millard's short balls were pulled with increasing authority — one was hammered behind square, another disappeared through the same region. When Gopal dropped short, Kishan rocked back and thumped the ball past square leg. The aggression was not reckless so much as earned.

His hundred arrived in fitting fashion. Gopal floated one just outside off and Kishan leaned into it, driving the rise past the non-striker, beating mid-off. He removed his helmet, raised his arms and accepted the applause.

For East, however, the story had begun much earlier as Kishan



East Zone captain Ishan Kishan celebrates his ton.

9P1

had elected to bat.

Abhinav Easwaran, playing on his 38th birthday, had looked set for his 28th first-class century. He made 72 from 86 balls, striking 10 fours and a six, and outscored teenager Vaibhav Sooryavanshi during an opening stand of 100. Sooryavanshi had entertained, as he has so often done, reaching 44 from 37 balls. Millard eventually found the answer — a short ball at 128kph pulled imperfectly towards deep midwicket where the catch was taken.

Easwaran's exit was considerably more painful. At 133/2, he steered off-spinner Tripuranan Vijay to point and set off. Shikhar Mohan took a few steps down the pitch before changing his mind and sending his partner back. By then Easwaran was nearly halfway down. He turned, but the fielder had moved quickly enough. The run-out was confirmed, leav-

ing Easwaran to walk away without even looking back towards Mohan.

Mohan made 85 from 120 balls before Millard's short-ball plan finally worked. He pivoted to turn one towards the leg side, but the ball took the inside edge and hit the stumps. That merely brought Kishan and Kumar Kushagra together.

Kushagra finished unbeaten on 63 from 75 balls, with five sixes, while Kishan continued to bat deep into the evening. East lost only four wickets, and every major batter except Sudip Kumar Ghoshani had made a substantial contribution. South, meanwhile, were left to contemplate a long second day as East established the terms of the final.

Brief scores: East 385/4 in 79 ovs (Ishan Kishan 111, K Kushagra 63, A Easwaran 72, S Mohan 85, V Sooryavanshi 44) vs South.

Gukesh becoming world champ had a huge impact on me: Yagiz

Susan Ninan

susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: At 15, Yagiz Kaan Erdogmus is already discovering that being the most talked about teen in chess right now comes with its own peculiar burden. In his case, first there are the rating goals. His coach, Azerbaijani grandmaster Shakhriyar Mamedyarov, has declared the never-before-seen 2900 as his Everest. The teen almost casually states a desire to become world champion "as young as possible" — a preference younger than Gukesh, who at 18 became the youngest undisputed world champion.

"Gukesh winning the world title had a huge impact on me," the precocious teen from Bursa, Turkey told HT. "I was surprised. It was an incredible thing. He played well and deserved to win against Ding (Liren). I also want to become world champion. I want to surpass Gukesh and become the youngest."

It is an ambitious clock to race against. Erdogmus knows it. The numbers do not seem to frighten him yet. Nor does the fact that Magnus Carlsen, the player he grew up idolising, has already told the world that he may be the best 14-year-old around. At 14, he became the youngest player to cross 2700 and says 2800 is a "barrier that even Carlsen hasn't breached."

He needs to get to 2750 first. There is something refresh-



Turkish teenager Yagiz Kaan Erdogmus.

MICHAEL WALLIS/AP

ingly adolescent about this confidence. He likes bullet chess, table tennis and tennis. He is happy to do so online. Though Mamedyarov, who touched a peak rating of 2820, has drawn the line at his protégé playing bullet.

On Sunday, at the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, student went up against the master and came away with a loss and a lesson. Playing for the PBC Alaskan Knights led by Vishwanathan Anand, Erdogmus

found himself staring at a checkmate threat set up by Mamedyarov, who turned out for CheQ Mumbai Masters, and resigned.

"When we solve positions together, he just sees everything immediately. He calculates really fast and really well," he said. "I'm more of a tactical player. I like going for sacrifices and I realise I'm quite positional. I'm also creative with my openings. My calculation is also very good. I prefer to discuss positions with my coach without looking at engines. I look at them later to not just know the answers but to try to understand why the moves work."

Classical chess may matter more to him, but for fun he turns to bullet chess. "I find bullet to be the most enjoyable format. Of course, classical is important. It's also more stressful because you need to achieve something that's like a really big goal. Gukesh became classical world champion that's why he's so popular."



Mercedes driver Kimi Antonelli celebrates on the podium.

AP

Antonelli wins after charge from behind

Reuters

sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

MONZA: Formula One leader Max Verstappen won his home Italian Grand Prix after a sensational race from 19th to first on Sunday in a massive blow for Mercedes teammate and closest championship rival George Russell.

The 20-year-old was the first Italian driver to win at Monza since Ludovico Scarfiotti for Ferrari in 1966.

Russell, who had led a re-start after Ferrari's Charles Leclerc crashed heavily at the end of lap two, finished second — 3.857 seconds behind — after being hunted down by a teammate on fresher tyres late in the race with Max Verstappen a distant third for Red Bull.

but instead ended up 66 adrift after 13 rounds.

"Oh my god, oh my god," screamed Antonelli over the team radio as he took the chequered flag as a winner for the seventh time this season and gave the crowd something to celebrate after Ferrari failed to match championship rival George Russell.

The Italian, who swapped the lead repeatedly with Russell before pitting during a virtual safety car period, while Russell stayed out, cut an S8 second gap to less than a second in 10 laps but then appeared to have wasted his efforts.

"Trying to pass, Antonelli went into the gravel with four laps to go but still came back and took back the lead on lap 51 of 53 before pulling away."

"Our Italian hero. So deserved. That was a fantastic lap. I hated the last one, but it was fantastic," commented Mercedes team boss Toto Wolff over the team radio after the flag. Russell said he did not have the tyres to fight back.

Jovic puts friendship on hold in three-hour battle with Eala

Shahid Judge

shahid.judge@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The point started with a baseline brawl, both players hitting with pace and intent. And then Iva Jovic threw in a forehead slice that drew Alexandra Eala towards the net. The rally continued with Jovic hitting from the back and Eala, at the net, stretching to keep her volleys in play. A volleyed winner finally ended the point in Eala's favour.

Through a majority of the exchange, the packed stands in the Arthur Ashe Stadium gave up on all semblance of tennis etiquette. When there was supposed to be silence, there was thunderous cheering. At the end of it, American Jovic and Filipino star Eala, smiling broadly, met at the net and high-fived each other.

This was in an exhibition match during the Fan Week at the Billie Jean King National Tennis Centre in New York ahead of the US Open.

On Saturday night, on that very court, 14th seed Jovic and 17th seed Eala played a competitive match, for ranking points, for a bigger chunk of the prize money, and a spot in the fourth round of the US Open. Neither had made it to the second week of the US Open, but on the night the rising 18-year-old Jovic faced the immensely popular 21-year-old from the Philippines, it was the teenager from California who came up trumps with a hard-fought 7-5, 3-6, 7-5 win.

"That felt like a marathon," Jovic said in her on-court interview. "I felt like I lost my sanity five times over to win that match. But it's really worth it for this feeling."

This was only the third instalment of what is expected to become the next big rivalry in women's tennis. Jovic had won both their previous matches in straight sets, but this was the first time they were meeting on hard court (Jovic is world No.14 and Eala No.18).

For just over three hours, the two battled it out for each point, pushing each other to all corners of the baseline, searching for winners through any gap they could find, defending with purpose when the back foot and hitting the ball as hard as they could.



Iva Jovic returns against Alexandra Eala during their US Open women's singles third round match at the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center on Saturday.

In the incident, with Jovic trailing 2-4, the American won three games on the trot and had a match point on Eala's serve. The Filipino held on though, and it looked like it would go into the match tie-break. With Eala serving to stay in the match at 5-6, Jovic had a second match point.

The crafty lefty pushed Jovic into a corner and aimed to strike a forehand winner only for the shot to hit the net.

Jovic sank to the floor. When she got up, Eala had already crossed the net to greet her.

What happened in the hard-fought contest showed the character of two fearless, aggressive players. But the exchange at the end told a story of a friendship between two fierce rivals on court.

"It says a lot about her as a person," Jovic said about Eala greeting her after the match. "To be able to do that after that type of match and still come over and hug me and wish me all the best. That just says a lot about her and her character."

Once using the tennis courts in her apartment complex to ride a bicycle and play football, it was only during the pandemic that Jovic really took to playing tennis, according to the US Open website.

In January, she became the youngest women's singles player since Venus Williams to reach the quarter-final of the Australian Open. It was followed by third and fourth rounds at the French Open

and Wimbledon respectively. At the US Open, she began her campaign with straight-sets wins over Magdalena Frech and Francesca Jones.

The high-quality match on Saturday saw both players hit more winners than made unforced errors (It was 44-27 for Jovic and 34-33 for Eala). "It took losing my earrings, falling literally flat on the floor, cuts on my knees, mental breakdowns," she said. "It took literally everything to somehow squeeze my way through."

The going gets tougher now as she next takes on former US Open winner Coco Gauff.

Saturday's match though will linger on, for a budding rivalry, high-quality tennis, and a wonderful friendship.

KEY RESULTS (THIRD ROUND)

MEN: Alexander Zverev (GER x1) bt Alejandro Tabilo (CHI x25) 6-2, 7-6 (7/2), 6-2; Luciano Darderi (ITA x21) bt Dane Sweeny (AUS) 6-4, 6-3, 6-3; Arthur Goe (FRA) bt Michael Zheng (USA) 7-6 (9/7), 3-6, 4-6, 6-3, 6-2; Learner Tien (USA x14) bt Jakub Mensik (CZE x17) 6-3, 7-6, 6-7 (2/7), 6-3, 6-4; Francisco Cerundolo (ARG x24) bt Taylor Fritz (USA x9) 3-6, 4-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4.

Alexander Bublik (BLR x28) bt Flavio Cobolli (ITA x5) 6-7 (4/7), 6-3, 6-0, 6-3

WOMEN: Mirra Andrejeva (RUS x3) bt Nikola Bartunkova (CZE) 6-2, 7-6 (7/5); Iva Jovic (USA x14) bt Alexandra Eala (PHI x17) 7-5, 3-6, 7-5; Coco Gauff (USA x4) bt Cristina Bucsa (ESP) 6-3, 6-4; Iga Swiatek (POL x8) bt Marie Bouzkova (CZE x25) 7-6 (7/3), 7-6 (7/3); Naomi Osaka (JPN x3) bt Elise Mertens (BEL x23) 6-3, 3-6, 7-5; Elena Rybakina (KAZ x2) bt Yulia Starodubtseva (UKR) 7-6 (8/6), 6-3

(FOURTH ROUND) Aryna Sablenka (BLR x1) bt Taylor Townsend (USA) 6-4, 6-3

Controlled aggression, the mantra for Priya in Asiad

Avishhek Roy

avishhek.roy@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: 'Ghus ke maar' (go in with your punches) is an instruction Indian boxing coaches often give their boxers during bouts. But when Priya Ghanghas is in the ring, it is quite the opposite. The coaches in her corner have to tell her to hold her fire, step back and fight from a distance.

Priya is perhaps the most hard-hitting and attacking boxer in the promising Indian women's line-up heading to the Asian Games in Japan. She packs power, aggression and a fighter's attitude into her game. Her close-range attacking style has been shaped by watching boxers from Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan. She is so hooked to their style that she watches videos of their bouts on a loop, to the point where their approach has become almost instinctive for her in the ring.

Once into a bout, Priya means business from the word go. She gets into her opponent's zone immediately and unleashes a barrage of punches. In just a year, she has made a swift rise to the top of Indian boxing. She now dominates the lightweight (60kg) category in India, having won a surprise gold at the Senior Asian Championships by beating some of the toughest competitors, before returning gold at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow.

This is my first Asian Games and I am only 20 years old, representing the country, so people have expectations from me. I also have a lot of expectations from myself, especially after winning gold at the Commonwealth Games. It has given me confidence," Priya told HT after training at SAIS NIS Patiala centre.

"I love to attack. I have learnt a lot by watching Kazakh and Uzbek boxers. I love their attitude. The way they enter the ring, it looks as if they are fighters. I try to carry the same attitude in the ring. They have good fitness levels and I have been working hard to improve. Watching them has taught me so much, even the way they come back and never give up during a bout," says the boxer from Bhiwani, a place that has produced some of India's most exciting



Know Priya Ghanghas

60kg Weight class: (lightweight) **Halls from Bhiwani** **AGE 20**

ACHIEVEMENTS

G Commonwealth Games 2026
S Asian U22 Boxing C'ships

G Asian Elite C'ships 2026
S National C'ships 2025

boxing talent.

However, an all-out attack can be a double-edged sword against smarter opponents, as she found out in Glasgow. It can drain energy levels early. If an opponent has a good defence and Priya's punches do not land, she can get rattled, and the relentless attacking style can take a physical toll as well.

"I like to fight at close range, but my coaches tell me that I am better off fighting from long range. When I am boxing closer to my rival, I hit them but maybe also take a few punches. In the first round at the CWG, I was up against a shorter boxer from Scotland (Niamh Mitchell) and I went all out from the first round, but I lost that round. The coaches then told me to fight from a distance. I followed it and beat her in the next two rounds."

In the final against Marie Al Ahmadi of Canada, Priya had to show restraint after losing the first round, but she made a stunning comeback to win the gold medal. She is still learning how to balance her aggression with good footwork and a disciplined game.

"The competition at the Asian Games will be far tougher than at Glasgow, but Priya is bolstered by her success at such a young age and the quality of opponents she has beaten at the Asian Championships, including former world champion Chengyu Yang of China and North Korea's Won Un Gyoung.

"I know it will be tough. I will have to beat Olympians and world champions from China, Kazakhstan, Chinese Taipei and I am prepared for the fight."

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

SMARTER FINANCIAL DECISIONS START HERE EVERY WEDNESDAY

INTRODUCING

Hindustan Times YOUR MONEY PERSONAL FINANCE. MADE SIMPLE.

Better financial decisions begin with better understanding. This weekly series helps you navigate money with greater confidence.



SPEND



SAVE



INVEST



PLAN

READ EVERY WEDNESDAY

